Nox User Guide

Version 0.5.0 · October 2026

Nox is a Mac app that runs your AI coding agents (Claude Code and Codex) for you. You say what you want; Nox works out the project, lets one agent build and the other review, each in its own copy of your repo, and asks you before anything risky. When the work is done you decide: keep it on a branch, send it back with the reviewer's notes, or throw it away.

This guide shows every screen, how to use each function, and a short demo you can follow on a throwaway repo.

> **About the pictures.** Every screenshot in this guide is Nox's real Mac or phone interface, taken by an automated test with demo projects (`demo-a` , `demo-b` , `nox-try`), simulated agents shown as Claude and Codex, a made-up user ("Alex"), a demo phone named **iPhone**, the demo address `nox-demo.tail0000.ts.net` , and a fixed clock (Thursday 15 October, 10:24). None of it is real work, a real person's device or a real tailnet.

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1. What Nox is

- **A command centre for coding agents.** One window shows your projects, what every agent is doing, and what is waiting for you.
- **You talk, Nox proposes, you confirm.** Type (or say) "in shop, fix the failing date test". Nox answers with a *proposal card* that shows exactly what will run. Nothing happens until you press **Confirm**.
- **Two agents, one team.** One agent builds (for example Claude), the other reviews (for example Codex). Each task runs in its own copy of your project, so nothing in your repo changes while the agents work.
- **The strongest models by default.** Claude tasks run Opus; Codex tasks run the model your Codex config names. Change the defaults in Settings, or pick a model for one task.
- **You stay in charge.** Risky commands wait for **Allow**. Finished work waits for **Keep work**, which puts it on the branch the task started from when that is safe (else on a new `nox/…` branch). Nox never makes a merge commit and never pushes.
- **Local core; private phone access.** Nox's main service and phone gateway listen only on `127.0.0.1`. A paired phone reaches the gateway through tailnet-only Tailscale `serve`; the agents use your own Claude and Codex logins.

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2. Install

What you need

- A Mac with Apple Silicon (M1 or newer), on macOS 13 or newer.
- Claude Code and/or Codex CLI, installed and logged in with your own account. Talking to Nox needs Claude Code.
- git 2.40 or newer at `/usr/bin/git` (it comes with the Xcode Command Line Tools). Check with `/usr/bin/git --version`.

Steps

1. Open the releases page: https://github.com/jimmy-nvx/nox-releases/releases
2. Download `Nox_0.4.2_aarch64.dmg` (or the newest version).
3. Double-click the DMG and drag **Nox** into **Applications**. Eject the DMG.

You install from the DMG once. Later versions arrive inside Nox (see Update Nox).

The first launch: "Open Anyway"

Nox is not notarized by Apple yet, so macOS blocks a normal double-click the first time. You do this once.

macOS 15 and newer

1. Double-click **Nox** in Applications. macOS says it could not verify Nox. Click **Done**.
2. Open **System Settings → Privacy & Security**.

3. Scroll down to **Security**. Next to the message about Nox, click **Open Anyway**. (The button shows for about an hour after step 1.)
4. Confirm with your password or Touch ID. If macOS asks once more, click **Open Anyway**.

macOS 13 and 14

1. In **Applications**, right-click **Nox** and choose **Open**.
2. Click **Open** in the dialog.

If macOS says Nox is "damaged", run this once in Terminal and try again:

```
xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine /Applications/Nox.app
```

What happens on first launch

- Nox starts its background service (a few seconds).
- It creates two items in your login Keychain (`pro.nvx.nox.api` and `pro.nvx.nox.audit`). If your Keychain is locked, macOS asks for your Mac password.
- macOS may ask for access to your Desktop or Documents folder when Nox looks for projects. Allow it if your code is there.
- A Nox icon appears in the menu bar, and Nox says hello out loud (you can turn that off in Settings).

Connect your agents

Nox does not log in for you; it runs the `claude` and `codex` commands you already have. Log in once in Terminal by running `claude` and/or `codex`, then check:

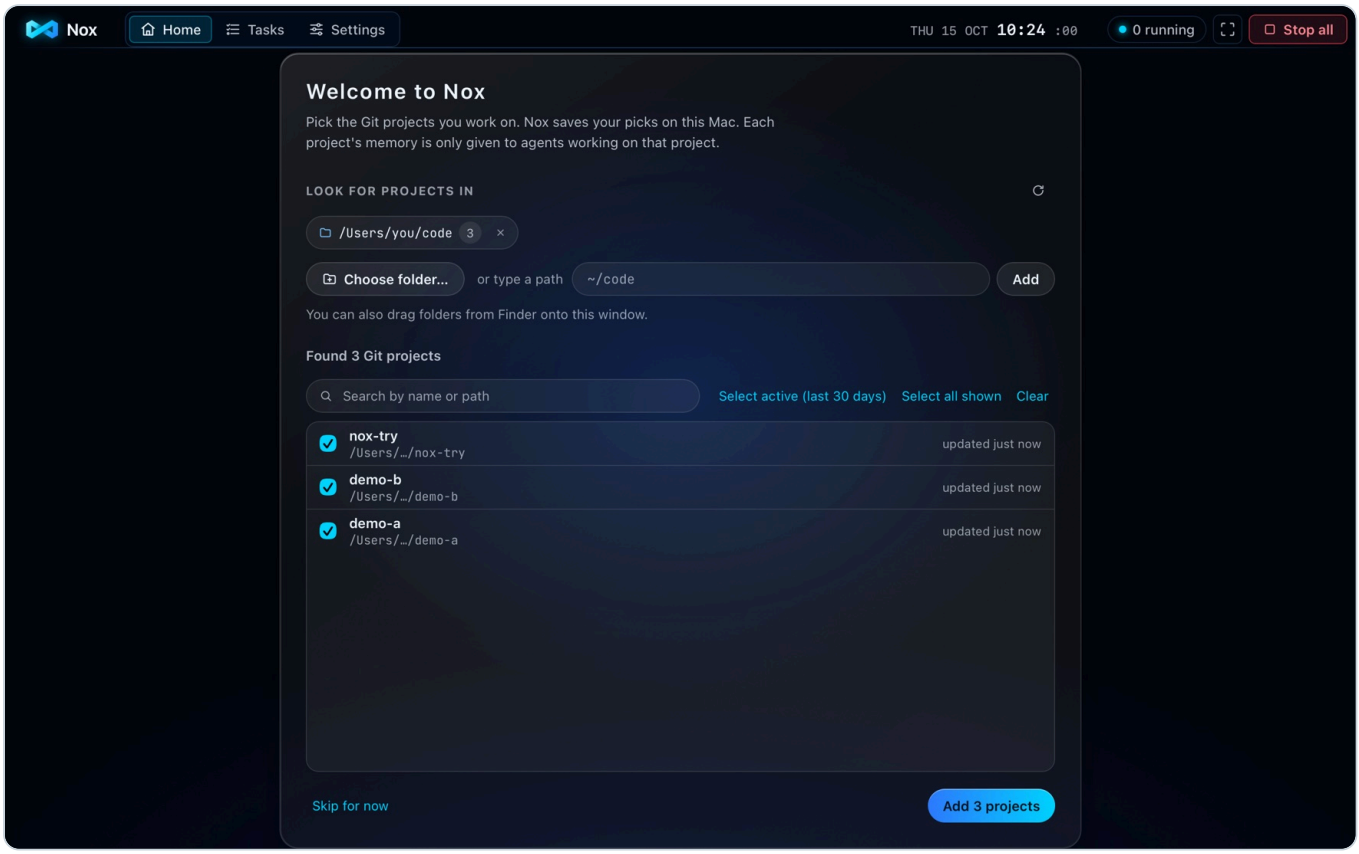
```
claude --version
codex --version
```

If you install an agent later, quit Nox, run `pkill -x noxd`, and open Nox again, so the service sees it.

3. The screens

Nox has three main screens: **Home** (`⌘1`), **Tasks** (`⌘2`) and **Settings** (`⌘,`), plus the **Review Desk** for one task. The header is always there: the screens, the clock, how many agents are running, how many things need you, full screen, and **Stop all**.

Welcome (first run)

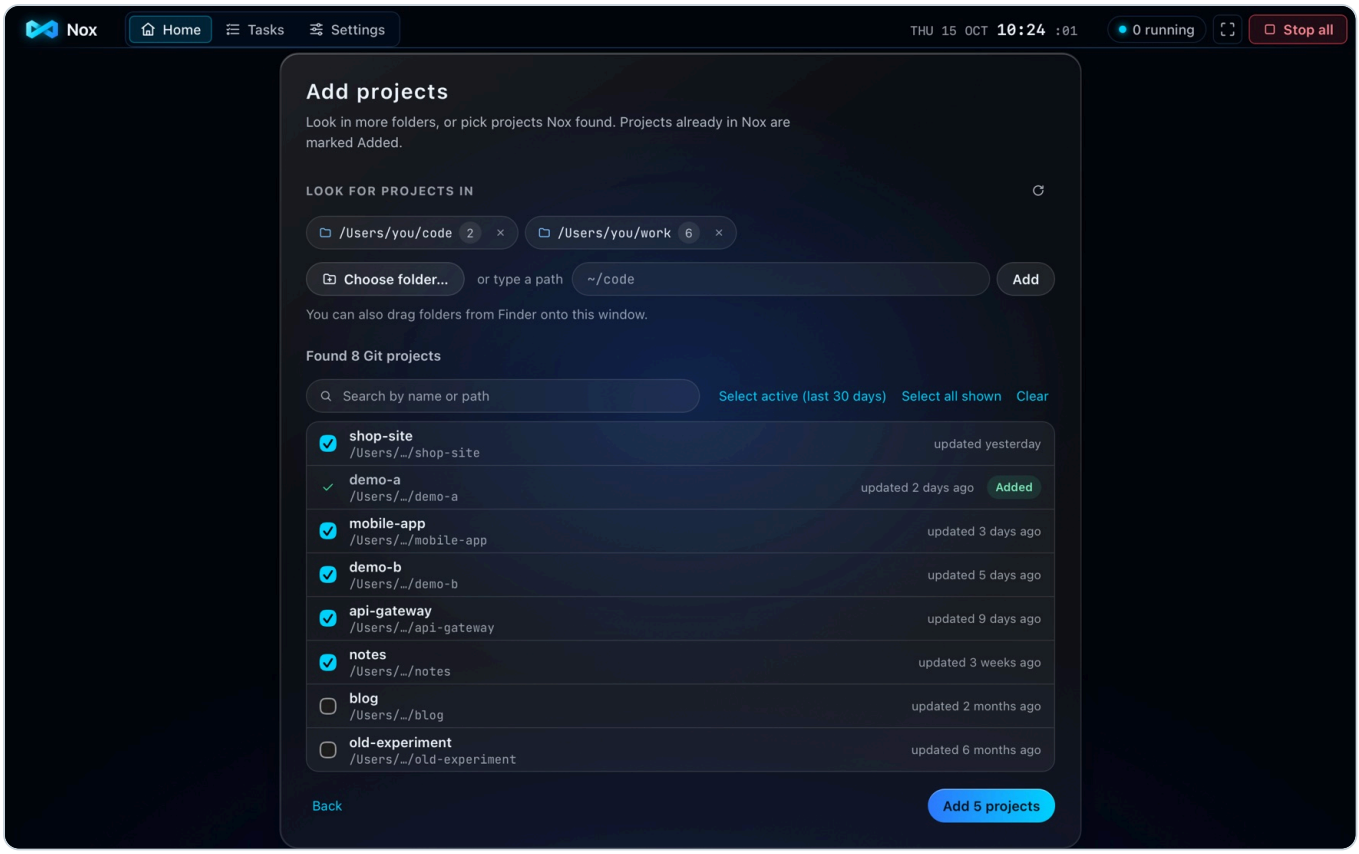


The Welcome screen after a scan, with three projects ticked

The first time you open Nox it helps you pick the Git projects you work on. It is the same screen you use later to add more (see Adding projects below).

- **Look for projects in** lists where Nox looks. Each folder is searched as soon as it is there: there is no Scan button.
- Tick the projects you want, then click **Add N projects**.
- **Skip for now** goes straight to Home.

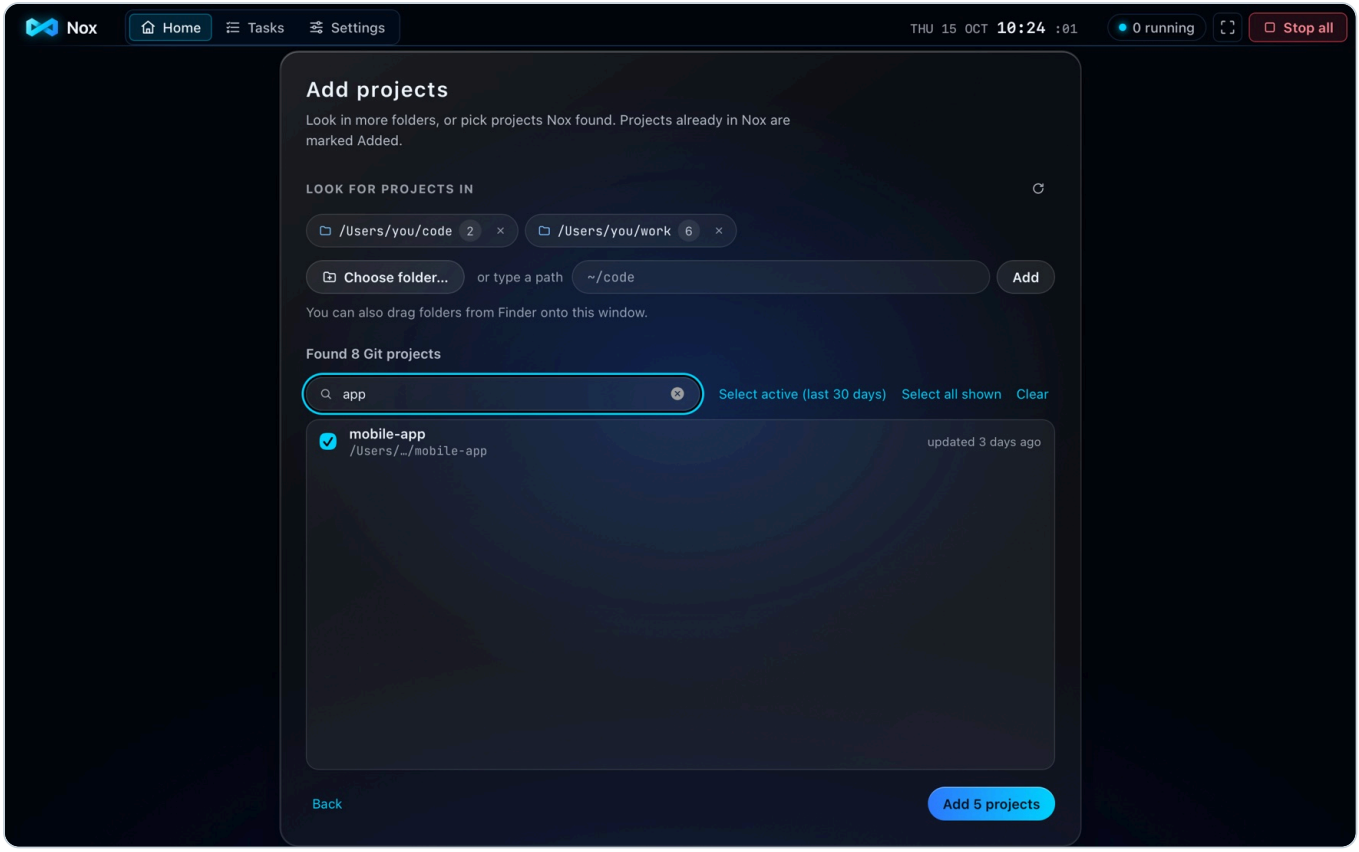
Adding projects



Add projects: two folders searched, eight projects found, five ticked, one already added

Open **Tasks → Add projects** whenever you want more projects in Nox. It is the Welcome screen again, and it works the same way.

1. **Choose a folder.** Click **Choose folder...** and pick the folder that holds your projects (for example `code`), or drag a folder from Finder onto the Nox window, or type its path (`~/code` works) and press **Enter**. If the folder is itself a Git project, it is listed at the top, already ticked. You can add as many folders as you like; the **×** on a folder's chip stops looking there.
2. **Read the results.** Nox lists the Git projects it finds, most recently used first (**updated yesterday**, **updated 3 weeks ago**). When there are many, they are grouped by folder. A folder Nox cannot read says why on its own line. While it looks, Nox only reads file names and dates: it never runs git in a folder you have not added.
3. **Pick.** Tick projects one by one, or use **Select active (last 30 days)**, **Select all shown** and **Clear**. Projects that are already in Nox say **Added** and cannot be ticked twice.
4. **Add.** Click **Add N projects**. **Back** leaves without adding anything.



Searching the results: only mobile-app matches "app"

The search box filters by name or path. **Select all shown** then ticks only what the search shows, which is a quick way to add a family of projects such as everything with `api` in its name.

Removing a project. Open a project's panel (click it on Home or in the Tasks list) and press **Remove from Nox...**. Nox forgets the project, its notes and its finished tasks. Your folder, its branches and its git history are not touched. If a task of that project is still running or waiting for you, Nox tells you which one is in the way.

Home



Home with nothing running

Home is where you spend most of your time.

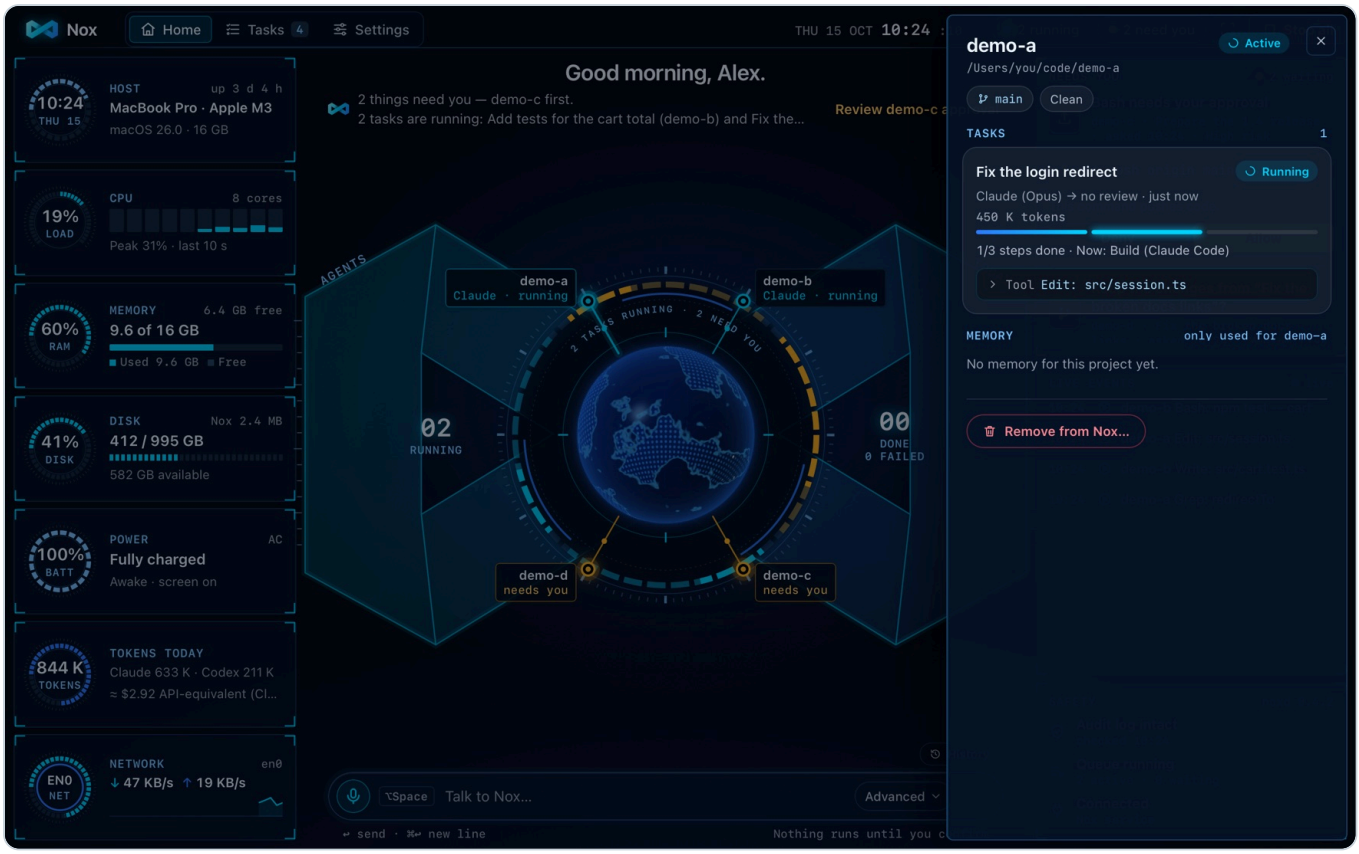
- **Centre: your projects.** Each project is a node on the ring around the globe, with its state (idle, running, needs you). Click a node to open the project's panel. The big numbers count running and finished tasks.
- **Top: the greeting and the Nox line.** The line under the greeting tells you the most important thing right now ("All quiet…", "2 things need you — demo-c first"), with a button that takes you there.
- **Left: this Mac.** The clock, CPU, memory, disk, power, network, and **Tokens today** (how much the agents used today).
- **Right: Needs you, Live events, Safety.** *Needs you* lists every decision waiting for you. *Live events* shows what the agents are doing, as it happens. *Safety* shows that the audit log is intact, whether the queue is running, the connection to the service. After a **Stop all** it also says **All agents stopped** and offers **Resume** (see Stop everything).
- **Bottom: the conversation bar.** Type to Nox and press **Enter**, tap the mic to speak, or open **Advanced** to start a task by hand.



Home while agents work: two running, a push waiting for approval

When agents are busy, the ring shows each task's progress as an arc, the nodes say who is working ("Claude · running"), and *Needs you* fills up. Here a `git push` waits for **Allow** or **Deny** (pushing is high risk), and a finished task waits for **Keep work** further down the list.

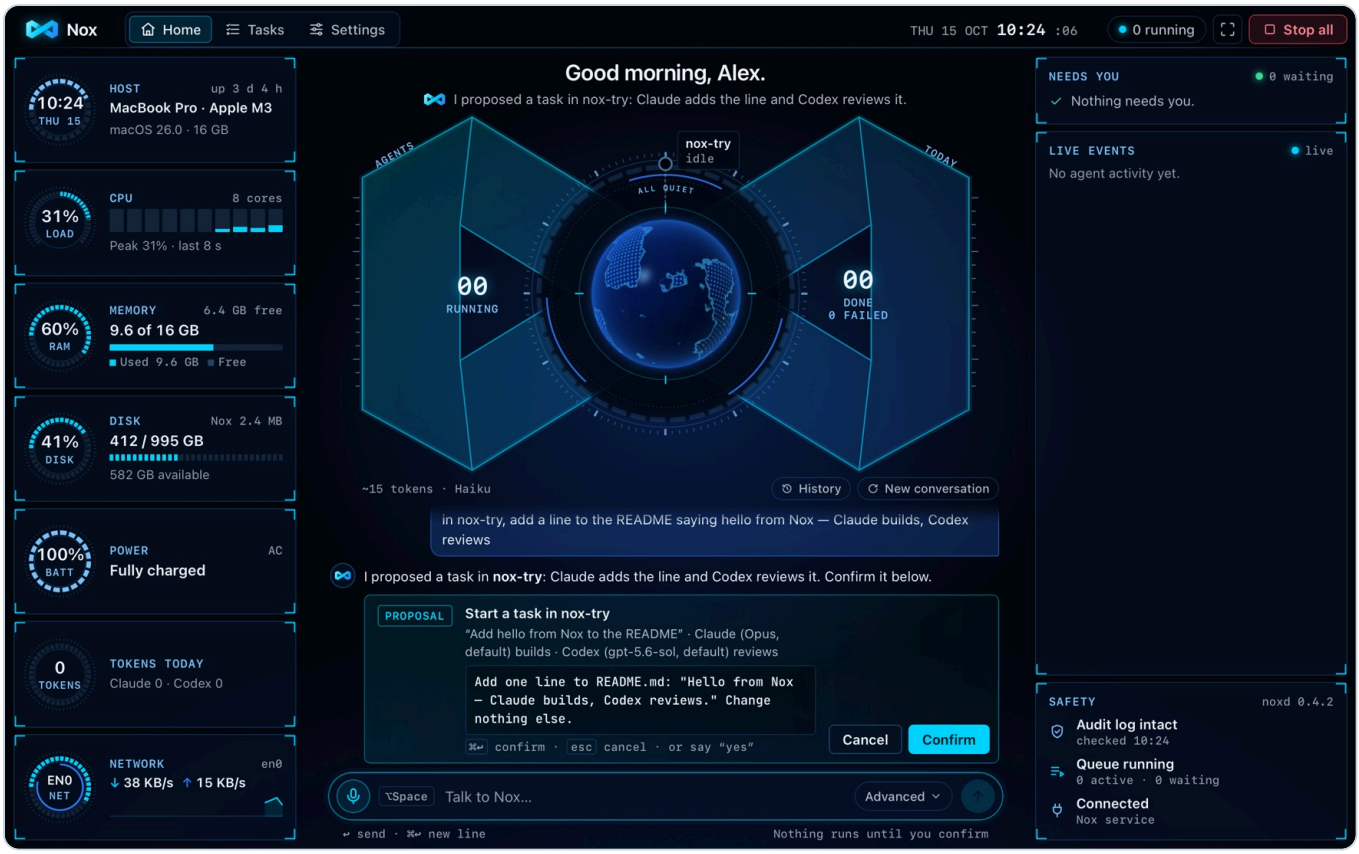
The project panel



The project panel for demo-a: its task, steps, tokens and memory

Click a project on the ring (or in the Tasks list) to open its panel on the right. It shows the project's folder and git branch, every task with its state, steps done, tokens used and the latest tool the agent ran, its approvals, and the project's memory (notes only that project's agents get). `Esc` closes it.

Talking to Nox



Nox's reply and a proposal card: start a task in nox-try, Claude builds, Codex reviews

Type in the bar and press **Enter**. Nox answers in a sentence or two. If your words ask for a change, the answer comes with a **proposal card** that shows exactly what will happen:

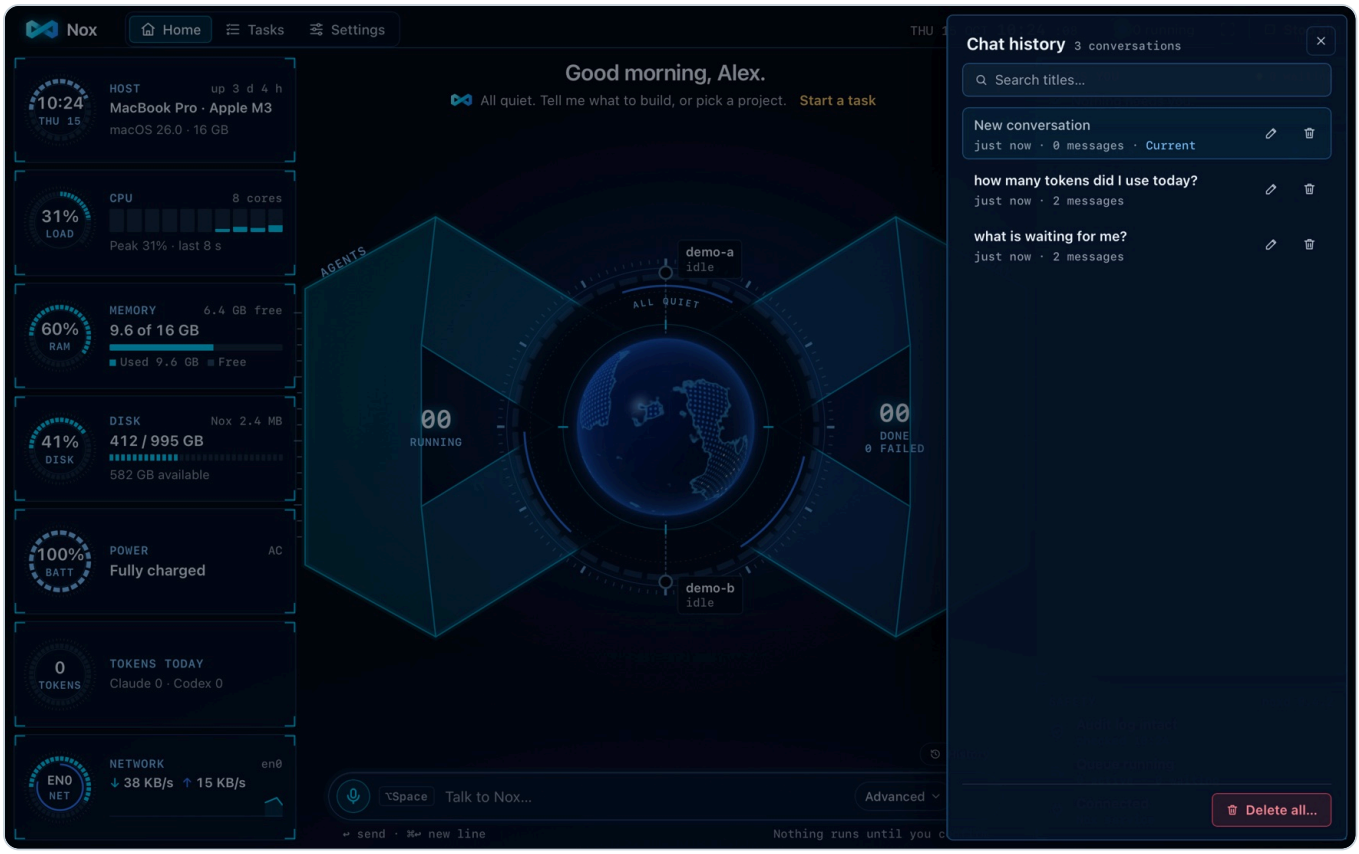
- what it does ("Start a task in nox-try", or "... on feature/login" when you named a branch),
- the task's title, who builds and reviews, and the model each runs ("Claude (Opus, default) builds · Codex (gpt-5.6-sol, default) reviews"),
- the agent's whole instructions, word for word.

Nothing has happened yet. Click **Confirm** (or press `⌘↩`, or say "yes" while the card is on screen) to run it; **Cancel** drops it. If the text is longer than the box, the button says **Scroll to read all** until you have scrolled to the end: you confirm only what you have read. A card you ignore expires after 10 minutes.

When you ask Nox to keep a task's work, its card says where the work goes: **Keep work → main: keep the changes from "..."**, or the `nox/…` branch and why not the branch the task started from. **Confirm** keeps it exactly there. If that changed in the meantime (someone committed to `main`), Nox says so, nothing is decided, and you ask again.

The small line above the thread (**~15 tokens · Haiku**) is what this conversation has used. **New conversation** starts afresh and keeps the old one in History.

Chat history



The History panel: three conversations, the one you are in marked Current

Nox keeps your conversations with it, on your Mac, until you delete them. Click **History** (next to **New conversation**, above the chat) to see them, newest first.

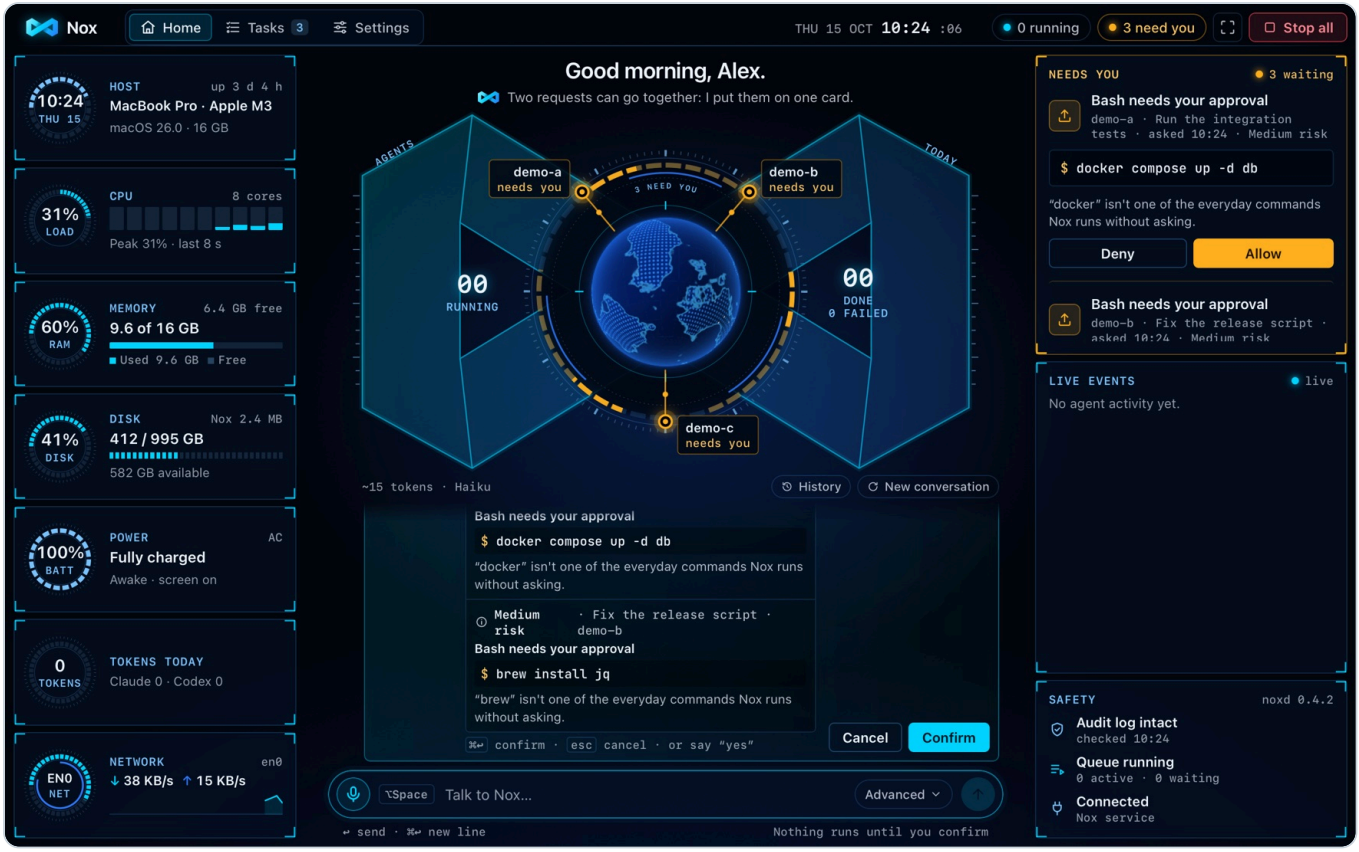
- **Open one** to see its messages again and carry on where you stopped. Nox remembers it, or gets a short recap when its old session is gone.
- **Search** filters the titles. A title is the first thing you said; the pencil renames it.
- **Delete** (the bin) removes one conversation after you confirm; **Delete all...** removes every one. This cannot be undone. Deleting a conversation also deletes the Claude Code session behind it.
- After a restart the chat shows the conversation you were in. Anything Nox hides on screen as a secret is never saved.

Several decisions on one card



The batch card: approve 2 requests, each with its risk, task, project and full command

Ask "approve the low-risk ones" (or "approve the test runs", "what's blocked?", "reject the push") and Nox puts several waiting requests on **one** card. Each request is listed in full: its risk level, task, project, the whole command and why it waits. A batch only ever holds requests from agents (a command or tool that waits for **Allow**). Low-risk commands run without asking, so what waits is medium or high risk, and only the medium ones can be approved together.



The end of the batch card with Confirm

Scroll to the end of the list; then **Confirm** decides them all.

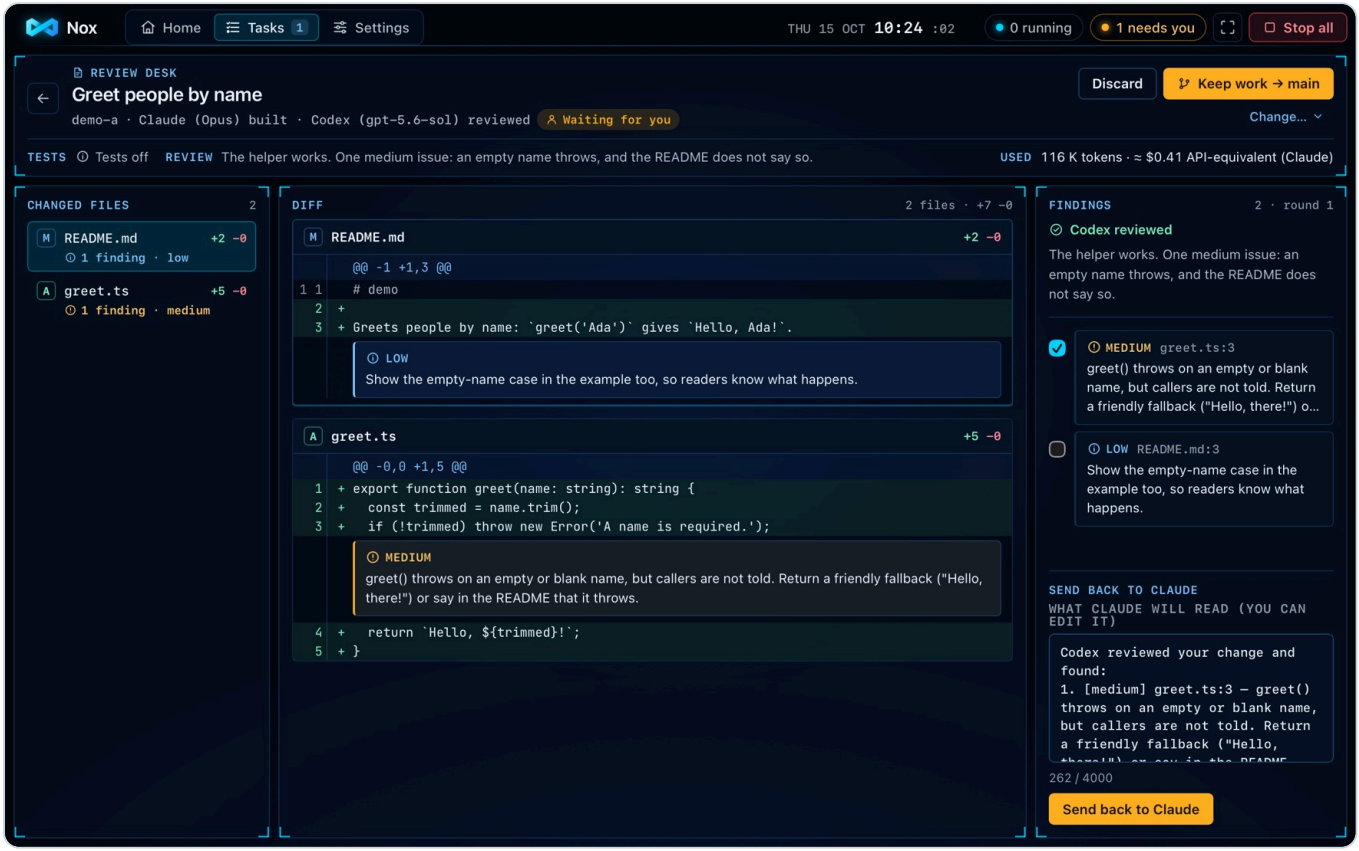


After Confirm: 2 approved, each marked Approved; the high-risk push still waits

Each request shows its own result (**Approved**) and the card sums up ("2 approved"). Two kinds of decision are never part of a batch:

- A **high-risk** request — here the `git push` — is decided one at a time: it stays in *Needs you* for you to decide on its own (rejecting one in a batch is fine).
- **Keep work / Discard** for a finished task. Nox answers "Keep or Discard is decided on its own card (open the Review Desk)": you decide it on its Keep card or in the Review Desk, where you see what you keep.

The Review Desk



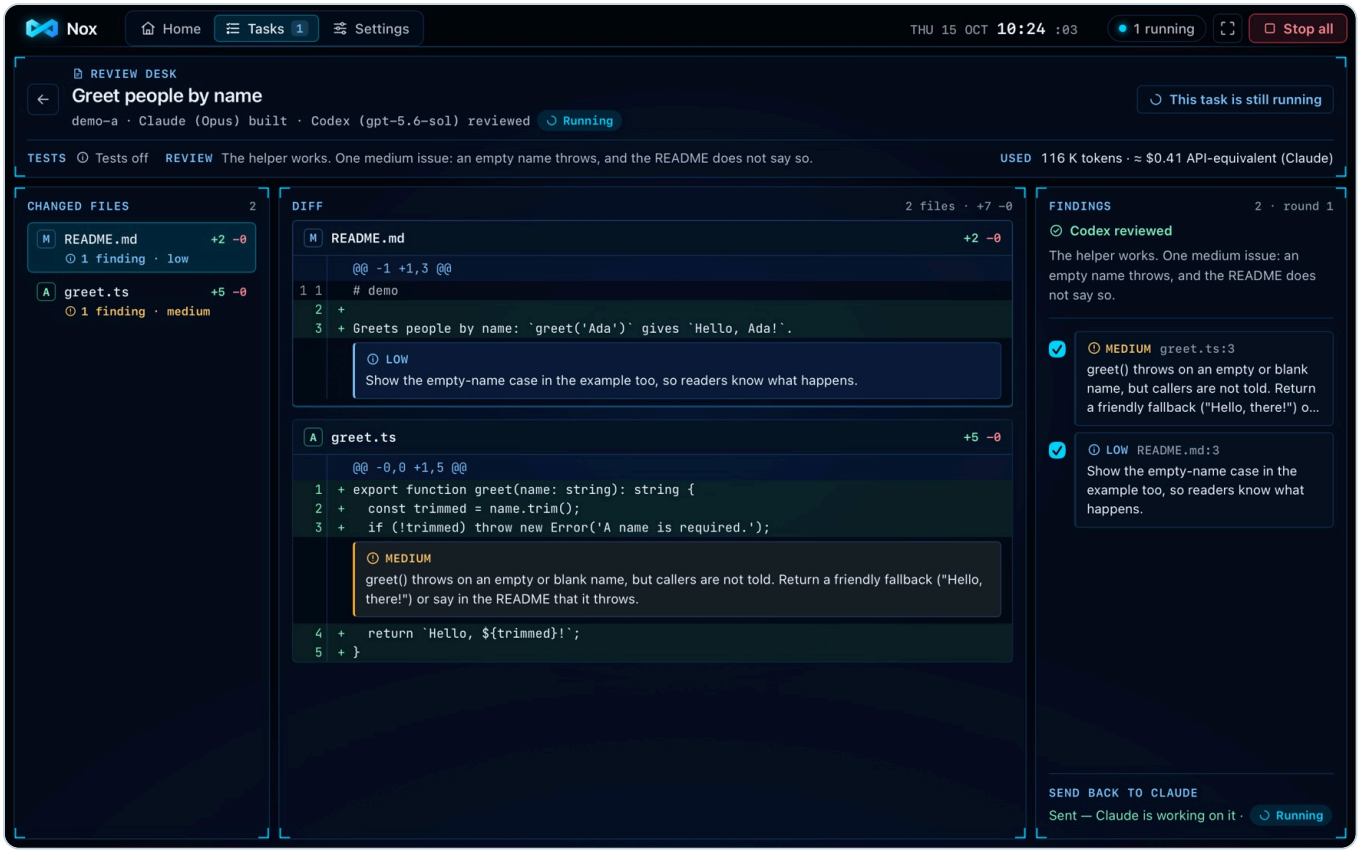
The Review Desk: changed files, the diff with findings pinned under their lines, and the findings

One screen per task that shows what the agent changed and what the reviewer said, so you can decide without opening an editor. Open it with **Open Review Desk** on a *Needs you* card, or **Review** next to a task in Tasks.

- **Top:** the task, its project, who built and who reviewed it, the test result, the reviewer's summary, and the tokens the task used (with "≈ $X API-equivalent" where Claude reports a cost).
- **Left — Changed files:** each file with its +/– line counts and how many findings it has.
- **Centre — the diff:** every added and removed line. Each finding is **pinned right under the line it is about**, with its severity as an icon and a word (High, Medium, Low).
- **Right — Findings:** all findings, worst first. Click one to jump to its pin. Below them is **Send back**.
- **Keep work →** (top right) puts the work on the branch the task started from when that is safe, else on a `nox/…` branch; **Change...** picks a new branch instead. **Discard** throws it away.

If an added line looks like a password or key, a red banner counts those lines and each one is marked "Looks like a secret — Keep would commit this". Remove it before you keep the work.

Send back



After Send back: "Sent — Claude is working on it"

To have the builder fix what the reviewer found: tick the findings (high and medium start ticked), read the text Nox wrote from them (you can edit it), and click **Send back to Claude**. The same agent continues in the same copy, remembering its work; then the review runs again and the desk shows the new round. Nothing is sent before your click.

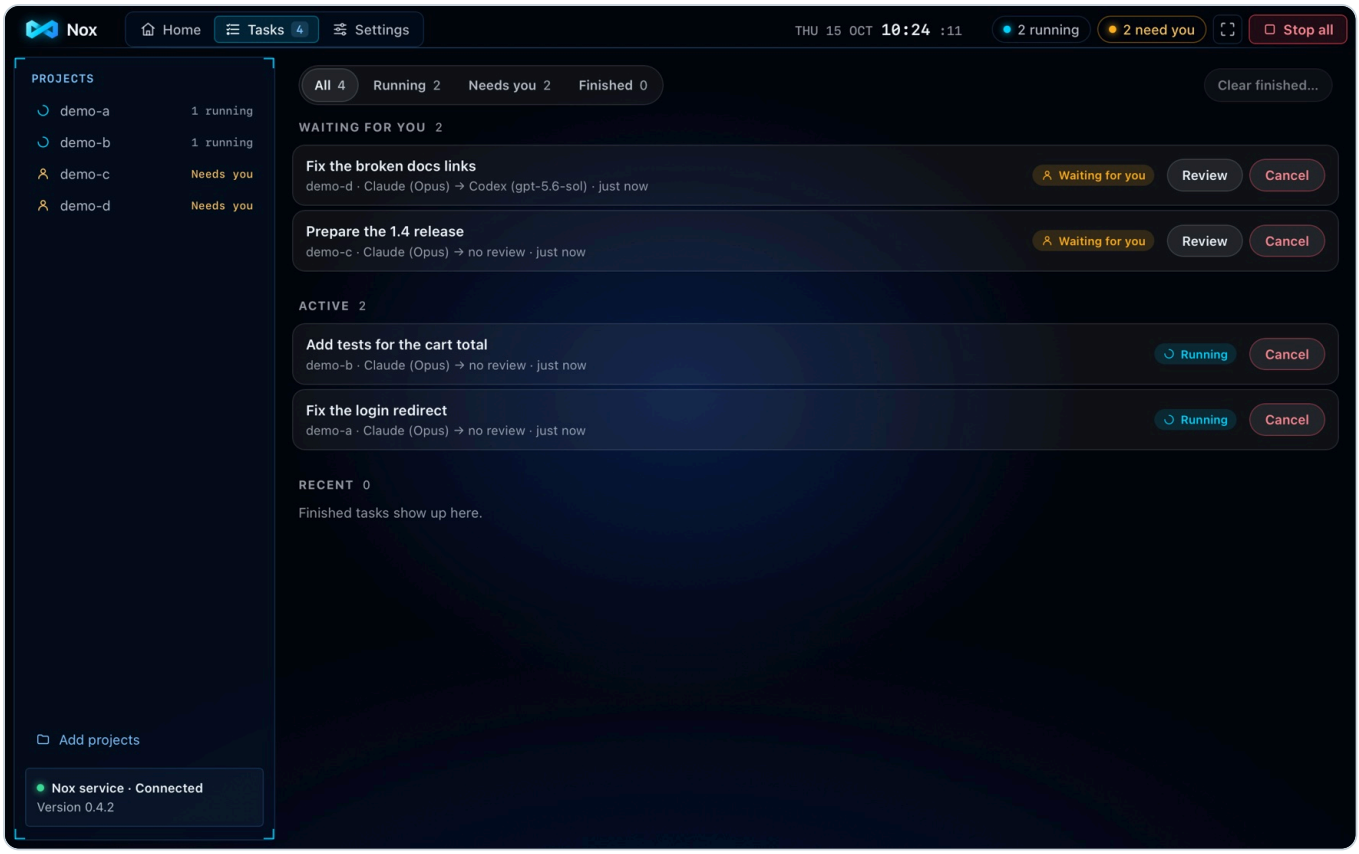
Tokens today and the budget card



A task past its budget: the budget card in Needs you, and Tokens today on the left

- **Tokens today** (left column) is today's total (the agents and the assistant), split into Claude and Codex (and the assistant, when you talked to Nox). "≈ $X API-equivalent" is what the same Claude tokens would cost at API prices; with a Claude subscription you pay nothing extra per token.
- **When tokens are counted.** Claude's tokens are counted as it works, message by message. Codex reports its tokens when each Codex turn ends (the first run, each follow-up, each review), so a Codex task is counted then.
- **The budget card.** Each task may use up to **3,000,000 tokens** unless you change it. When a task passes its budget **while its agent is working** (planning, building, testing, or stopped on a request for you), a card asks you: **Let it finish** (doubles that task's budget) or **Stop it** (asks once, then cancels the task and discards its work). Ignoring the card does nothing: the task keeps running. Nothing stops by itself. Once a task waits for **Keep work**, there is no budget card: nothing more is being spent, and the Keep card decides the task.

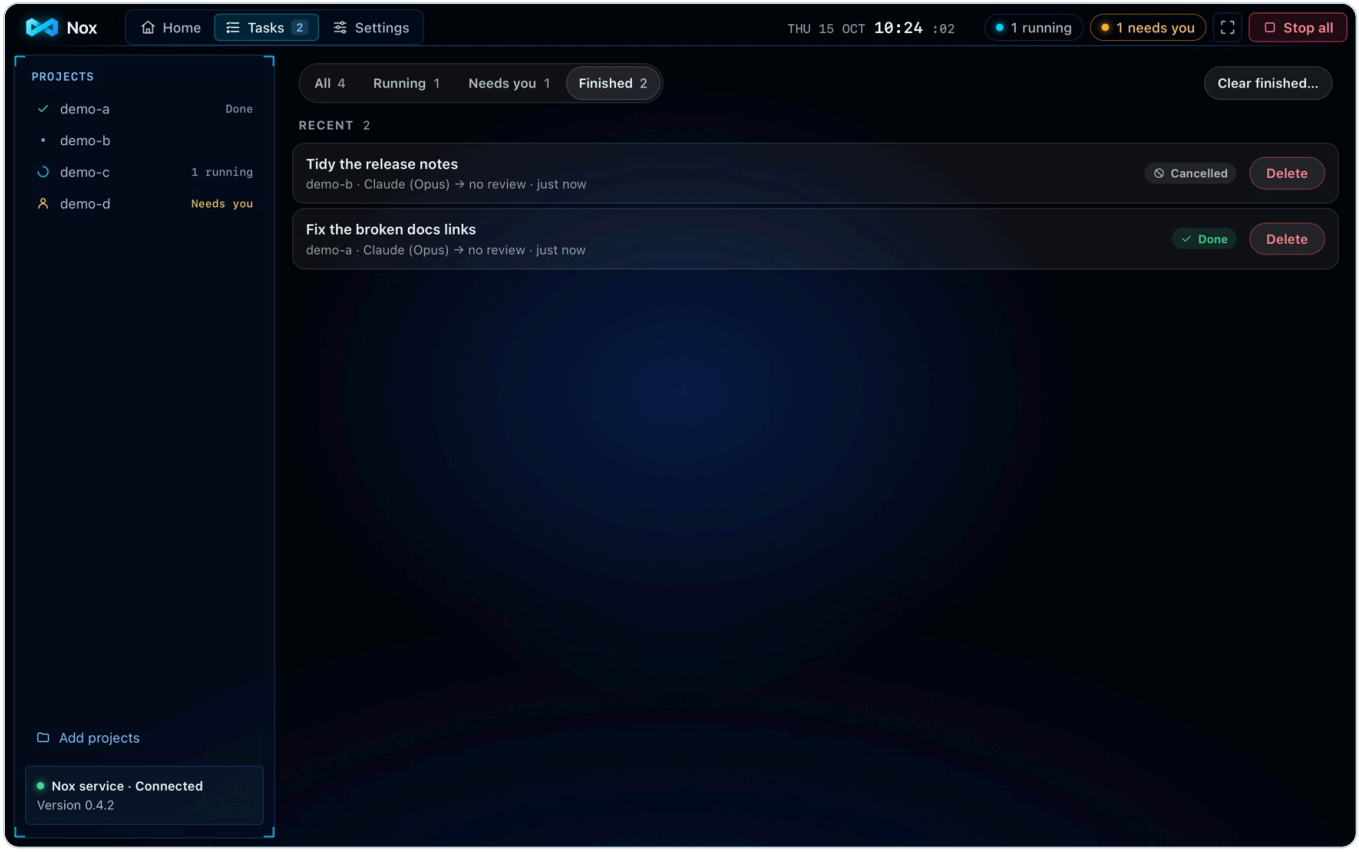
Tasks



Tasks: projects on the left; tasks waiting for you, active and recent

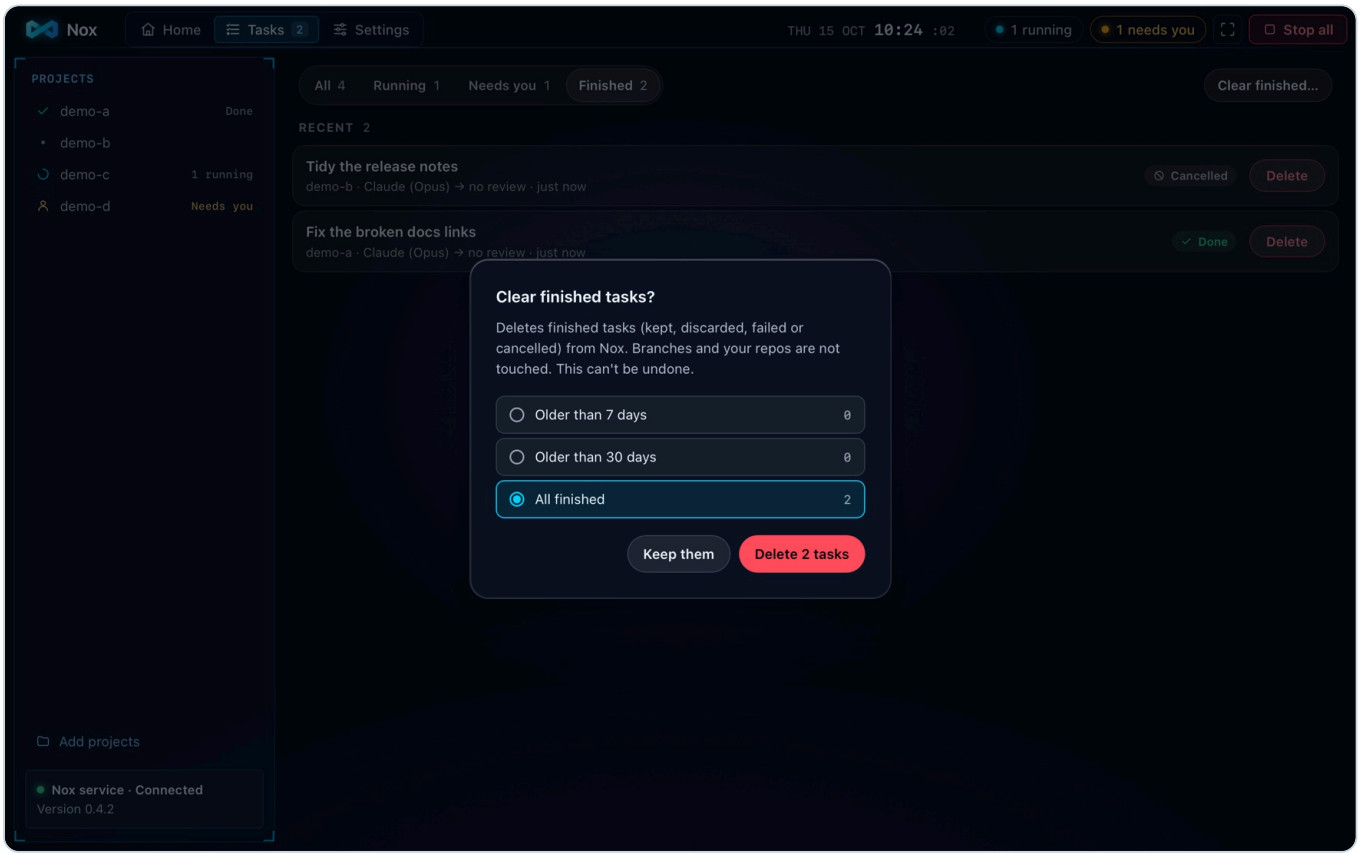
Every task, grouped as **Waiting for you**, **Active** and **Recent**, with its project, who builds and reviews it, and its state. **Review** opens the Review Desk; **Cancel** stops a task and discards its work. The left side lists your projects (click one to open its panel) and **Add projects**.

The **filter** at the top shows **All**, **Running**, **Needs you** or **Finished**, each with its count. Nox remembers your choice while the window is open.



The Finished filter: a kept task and a cancelled one, each with a Delete button

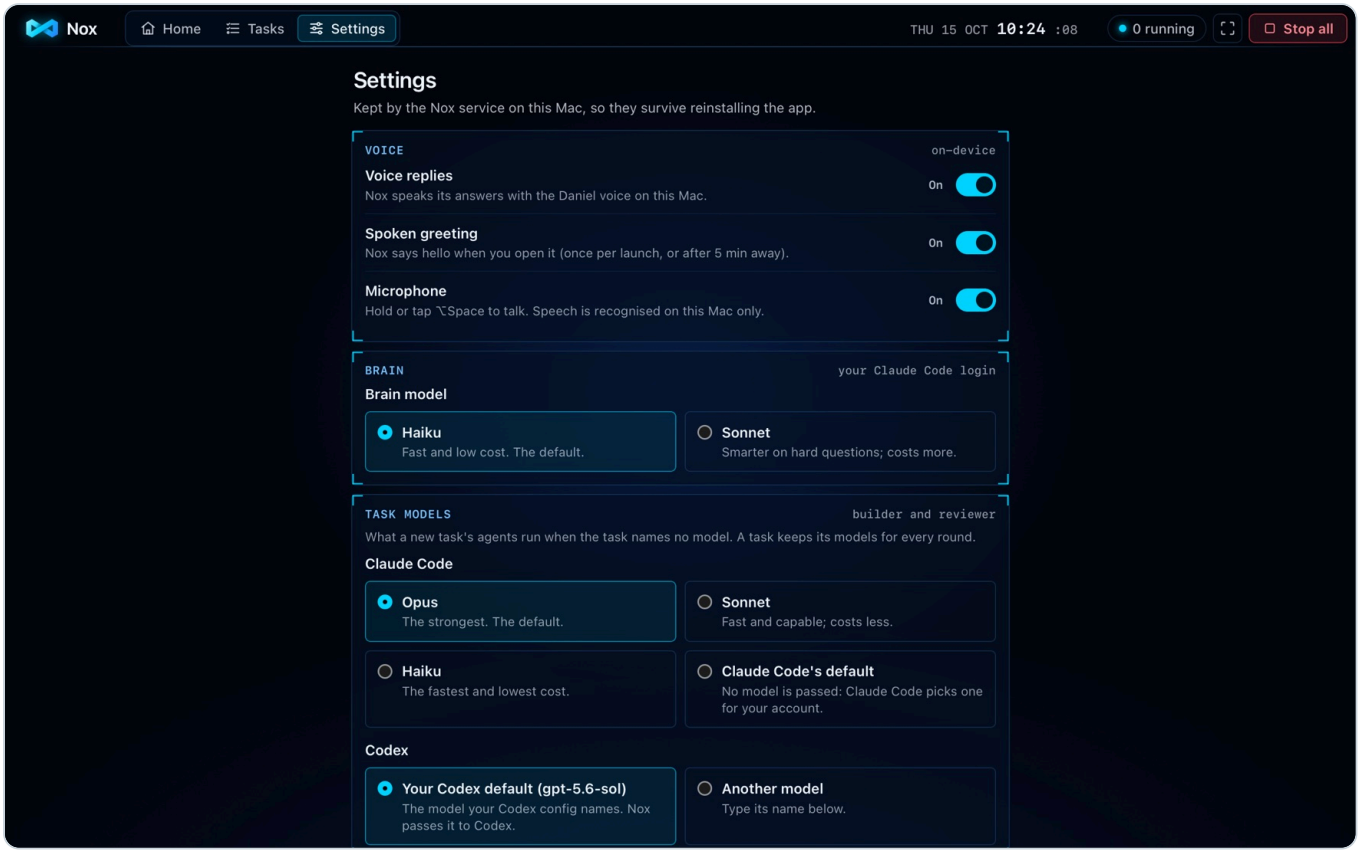
A finished task has a **Delete** button. It removes only Nox's record of the task: its branch and your repo are never touched, and **Tokens today** stays the same. A task that is running or waiting for you cannot be deleted; cancel it first.



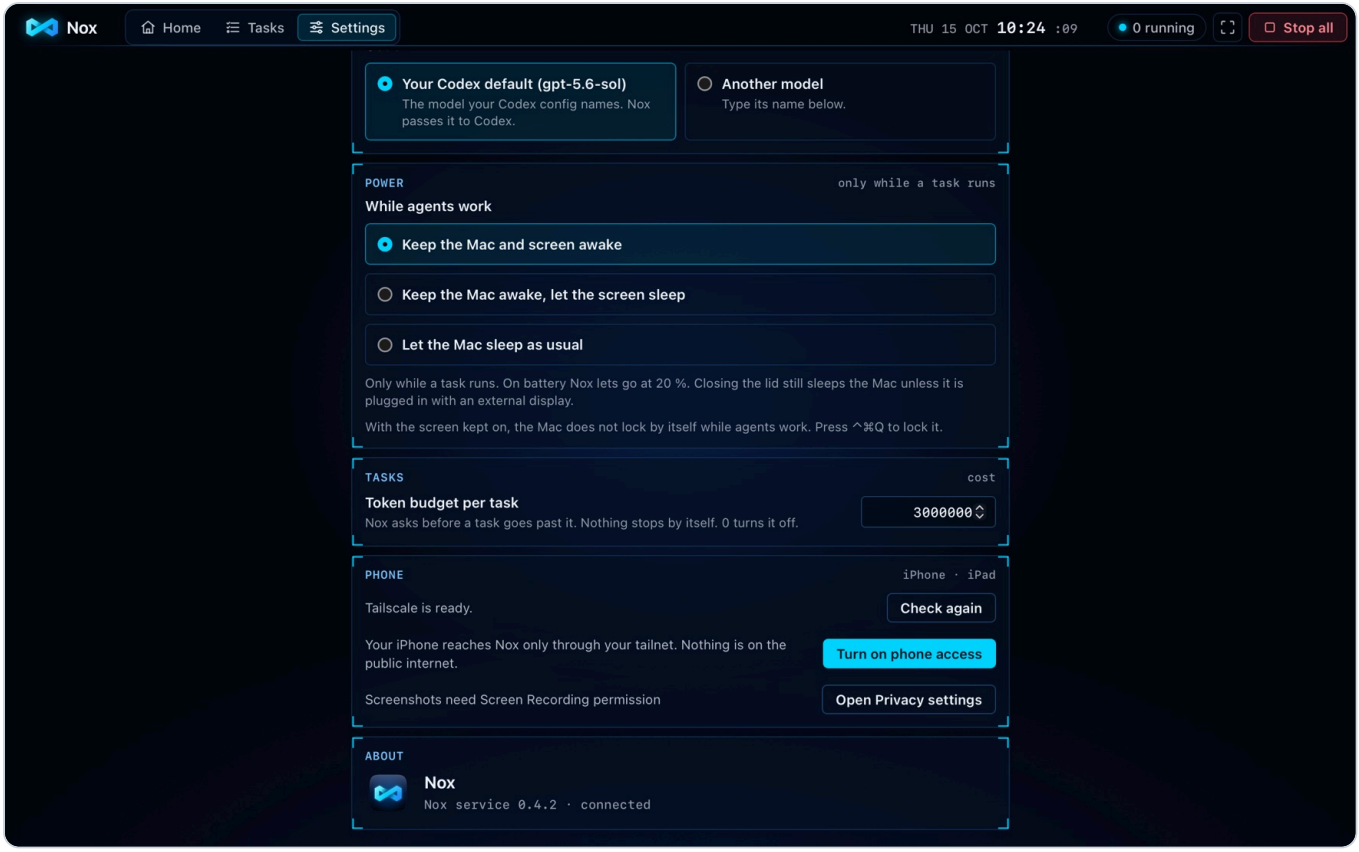
Clear finished tasks: older than 7 days, older than 30 days, or all finished

Clear finished... deletes many at once. Choose **Older than 7 days**, **Older than 30 days** or **All finished** (each shows how many it would remove), then confirm. **Keep them** closes the window without deleting anything.

Settings



Settings: voice, the brain model, and the task models

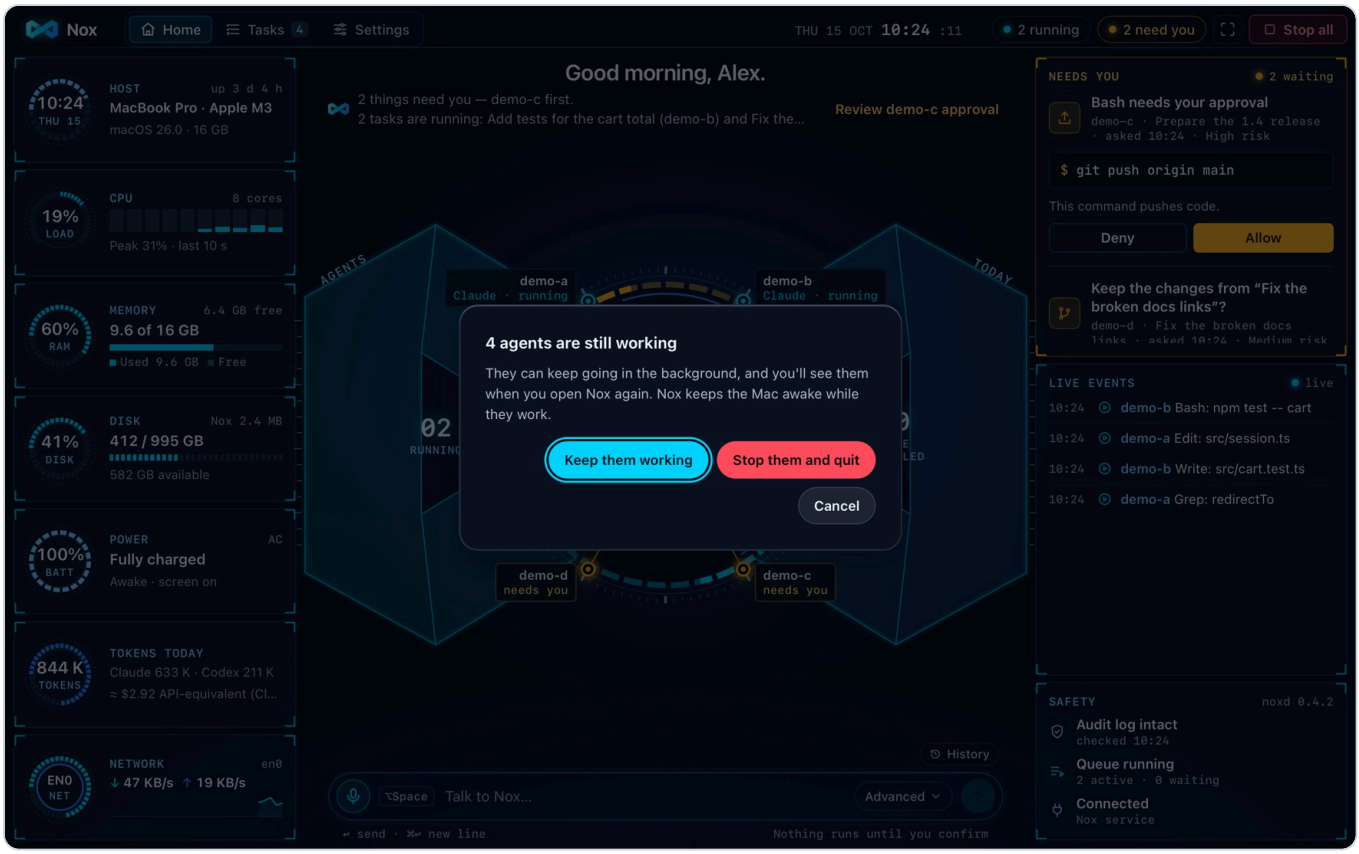


Settings, further down: the task models, power, the token budget per task, and About

Setting	Default	What it does
Voice replies	On	Nox speaks its answers (the Daniel voice).
Spoken greeting	On	Nox says hello when you open it.
Microphone	On	Lets you talk to Nox. Off disables the mic.
Brain model	Haiku	The model Nox's assistant uses. Haiku is fast and cheap; Sonnet is smarter and costs more. Only the assistant: task agents have their own models (next rows).
Task models → Claude Code	Opus	The model a new Claude task runs when you name none: Opus (the strongest), Sonnet, Haiku, or **Claude Code's default** (Nox passes no model).
Task models → Codex	Your Codex default	The model your Codex config names (for example **Your Codex default (gpt-5.6-sol)**). When the config names none, or uses a provider other than OpenAI, this reads **Codex's built-in model** and says why. **Another model** lets you type a name.
While agents work	Keep the Mac and screen awake	Or keep only the Mac awake, or let it sleep as usual. Only while a task runs; on battery Nox lets go at 20 %.
Notch	All on	**Nox Notch**, **Show on screens without a notch** and **Pop-ups**. See The Nox Notch.
Help	—	**Show tour again**.
Token budget per task	3,000,000	When Nox asks about a task's tokens. `0` turns budgets off. Press **Enter** to save.

Task models apply to tasks you start after the change: a task keeps the models it started with for every round (follow-ups, **Resume** and the reviews after them). Settings are kept by the Nox service, so they survive reinstalling the app.

Quitting with agents at work



The quit dialog: 4 agents are still working

Closing the window only hides it; Nox keeps running in the menu bar. When you **quit** (`⌘Q`, or **Quit Nox** in the menu-bar icon) while agents are working, Nox asks:

- **Keep them working** — the app quits; the service and the agents carry on, and you see them when you open Nox again.
- **Stop them and quit** — stops the agents and the service too.
- **Cancel** — keeps Nox open.

With no agent working, Quit simply stops everything.

The tour

The first time you open Nox, right after Welcome (once you add a project or press **Skip for now**), a short tour lights up seven places in turn: the message box, the ring, **Needs you**, **Tasks**, `⌘K`, the menu-bar icon and **Phone**. Use `←` `→` or **Back** / **Next**; `Esc` or **Skip** ends it. To see it again, go to **Settings → Help → Show tour again** (or **Help → Show the Tour Again** in the menu bar).

What's new

The first time you open a new version, a card shows what changed, with **Open the guide**, **Take the tour** and **Got it**. It shows once per version. Nox remembers that in its own settings, so clearing the window's data does not bring it back.

Help inside Nox

The **?** button in the header, `⇧⌘/` or **Help → Nox Guide** opens this guide inside the Nox window. It comes with the app, so it works offline, and links between its sections jump inside it.

The Nox Notch

A small pill around the MacBook notch shows what your agents are doing, always in words. On a Mac or screen without a notch it is a small pill at the top centre of the main screen. It floats over full-screen apps and never takes focus until you click it.

Colour	Means
Blue	Tasks are running ("2 running")
Orange	Something needs you ("1 needs you")
Red	A task failed; it stays for 10 minutes

- **Point at it, or click it,** to open a small panel. **Needs you** has **Allow**, **Deny** and **Always allow here** for low- and medium-risk requests (**Open** for high risk and for Keep). **Running** has **Stop**. **Open Nox** is at the bottom. The panel closes when the pointer leaves, or with `Esc`.
- **A stray click never approves.** The buttons wake up a moment (0.6 seconds) after the panel opens, and again when its rows change, so a click meant for the browser tab under the notch cannot approve anything.
- **Pop-ups.** When something needs you, a review is ready, or a task finishes or fails, the pill widens for 3 seconds with one line. One at a time, and never while the panel is open.
- **Turn it off** in **Settings → Notch**: **Nox Notch**, **Show on screens without a notch** and **Pop-ups** (all on by default).

The update pill



The header with "Update available — v0.4.3" and an Update button



The update pill while downloading: 9.3 of 24.8 MB, the speed and the time left

Nox checks for a new version 20 seconds after it opens, then every 6 hours. When there is one, the header shows **Update available** with an **Update** button. Click it: the pill shows the real progress of the download, in megabytes, with the speed and the time left (**Downloading 9.3 of 24.8 MB · 2.9 MB/s · ~10 s left**). For the first second or two it says **calculating…**. If no data arrives for a minute it says **Waiting for the network…** instead of sitting still, and the download carries on when the network is back. Then comes installing, and Nox restarts.

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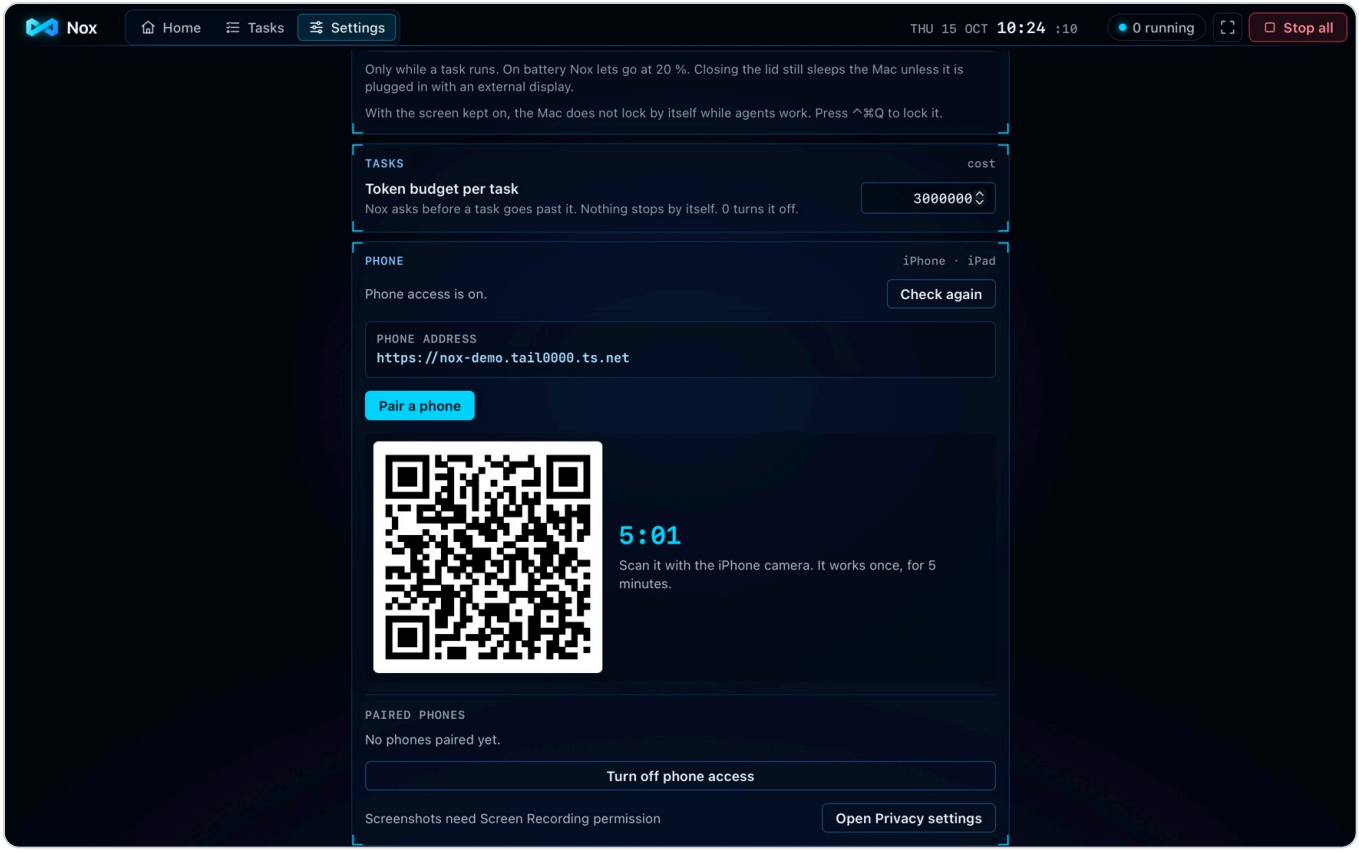
4. Your phone

Nox has a small iPhone and iPad interface (new in 0.4.0) for the times you are away from the Mac. It travels privately over your own Tailscale network—not the public internet—and works while the Mac is awake with Nox and Tailscale running. You can see what is running and waiting, answer requests, keep or discard work, talk to Nox, continue or stop tasks, stop all agents, and take a screenshot of the Mac's main display.

One-time setup

You do this once. It takes about ten minutes.

1. **Install Tailscale** on the Mac (from tailscale.com/download) and on the iPhone or iPad (from the App Store).
2. **Sign in to both with the same Tailscale account** and turn Tailscale on.
3. **Switch on two options.** Open the Tailscale admin console in your browser, go to the **DNS** page, turn on **MagicDNS**, then turn on **HTTPS Certificates**.
4. **Check in Nox.** Open **Settings → Phone** and press **Check again**. Nox checks each requirement and tells you the next step; when all is well it says **Tailscale is ready.**
5. **Turn on phone access.** Press **Turn on phone access**. Nox uses Tailscale `serve` for your own network only; it never uses Funnel, so nothing is on the public internet.

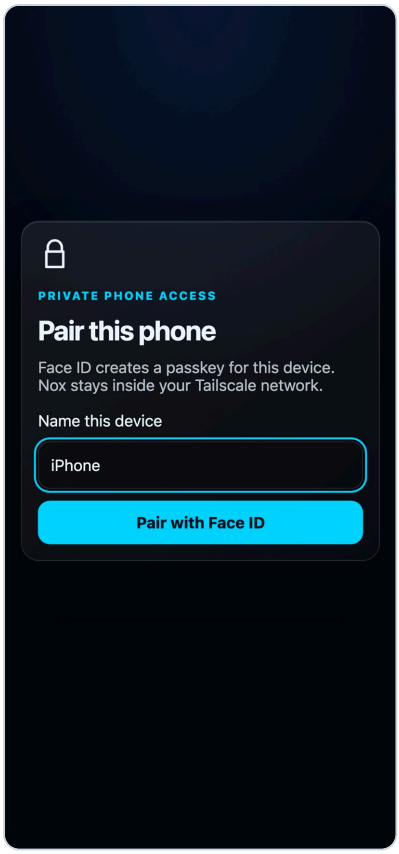


Settings → Phone with access on: the private address, a pairing QR code and the paired phones

Pair a phone

1. In **Settings → Phone**, press **Pair a phone**. A QR code appears; it works once and expires after 5 minutes.
2. Scan it with the iPhone or iPad camera and open the link in Safari.
3. Give the device a name and press **Pair with Face ID**. Face ID creates a passkey for this phone.

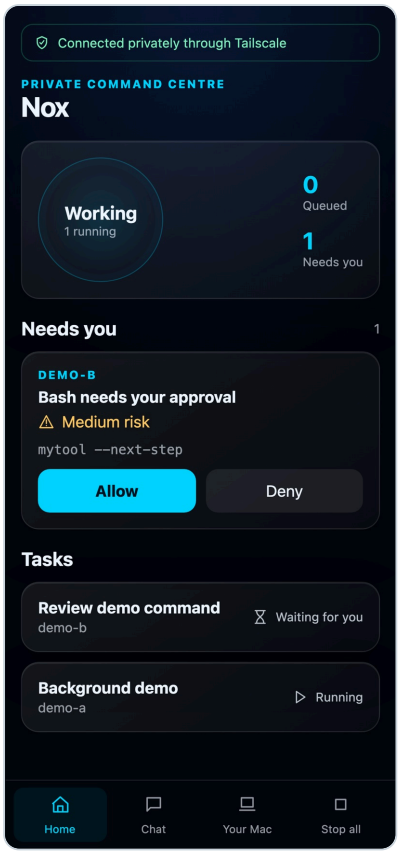
The demo uses `https://nox-demo.tail0000.ts.net` and names the device **iPhone**; your screen shows your own private address and the name you choose.



Pair Nox: name this device iPhone, then pair with Face ID

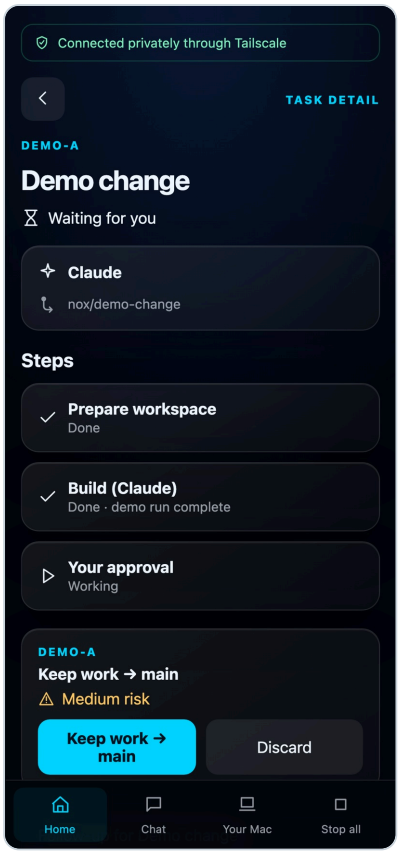
In Safari, choose **Share → Add to Home Screen** if you want Nox beside your apps. After 12 hours without use the phone asks for Face ID again; a session always ends after 30 days. See Phone (iPhone and iPad) (see the Setup guide) for the full setup, permission and troubleshooting steps.

Home and tasks



Nox phone Home with demo-a and demo-b, status, Needs you and running tasks

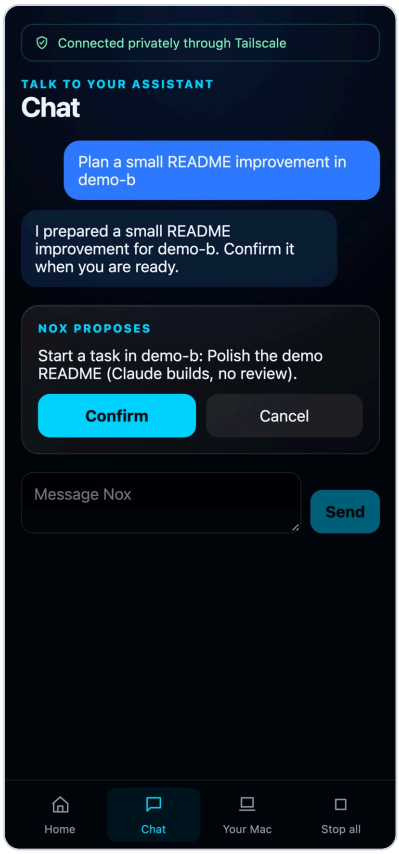
Home shows whether the queue is running, today's tokens, what needs you, and active tasks. **Allow** and **Deny** use the same rules as the Mac. A low- or medium-risk approval does not ask for Face ID; allowing a high-risk request does.



A finished demo-a task on the phone, waiting for Keep work → main or Discard

Open a task for its state, steps, models, branch and review summary. You can continue or stop active work. **Keep work** and **Discard** ask for Face ID, and the Keep button names the exact branch before anything changes.

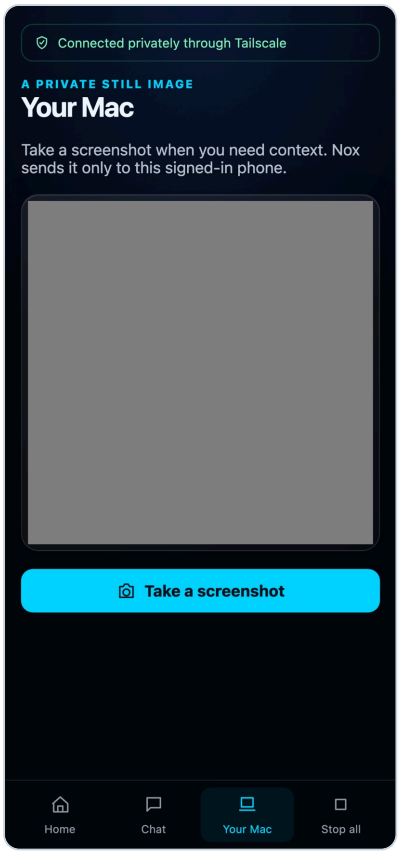
Chat



Talking to Nox from the phone, with a proposal card

The phone chat uses the same Nox assistant and proposal cards as the Mac. You still read and confirm every proposed action. The phone keyboard's dictation works in the text box; Nox does not use the phone microphone itself. Phone notifications are not part of Nox yet.

Your Mac and Stop all



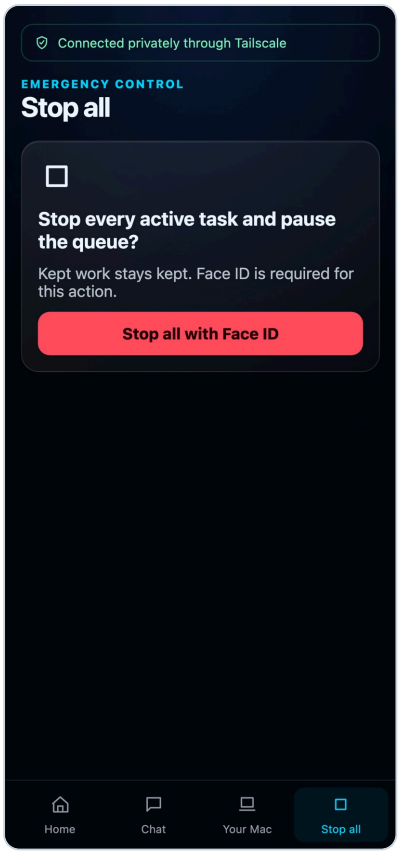
Your Mac on the phone, with its status and a screenshot of the demo Mac

Your Mac shows its current status, takes a screenshot on demand, and (new in 0.5.0) can show the Mac's screen live. The live screen is off by default. To use it:

1. On the Mac, turn on **System Settings → General → Sharing → Screen Sharing**. If it is off, the phone tells you.
2. In Nox, turn on **Settings → Phone → Allow Your Mac screen**.
3. On the phone, open **Your Mac** and press **Watch live**. macOS asks for the Mac's user name and password inside the page. Nox hands them straight to macOS and never stores your Mac password.
4. It starts **view-only**: pinch to zoom, drag to look around, double-tap to fit. Nox blocks every key, click and clipboard message until you take control.
5. **Take control** asks for Face ID. Then a tap is a click, a two-finger tap a right click, and a two-finger swipe scrolls. **Move view** / **Use Mac** switches what touches do. The key bar has ⌘ ⌥ ^ ⇧, Esc, Tab and the arrows, and the phone keyboard types on the Mac. **Release control** goes back to watching.

A session ends after 10 minutes without a touch and always after 60 minutes ("Session ended — start again"; control needs Face ID again). Nox connects only to Apple's own Screen Sharing service on your Mac; if the program on the other end is anything else, it says so and sends nothing. Starting, control and the end are in the audit log.

For a plain still image, the screenshot needs macOS **Screen Recording** permission for Nox and is limited to one every 3 seconds.



Stop all on the phone, ready to confirm with Face ID

Stop all stops every agent and pauses the queue after Face ID. **Resume the queue** does not ask again.

What needs Face ID

Only six things ask for Face ID on the phone:

- **Pairing** a phone,
- **Keep work**,
- **Discard**,
- **allowing a high-risk request** (a push, for example),
- **Stop all**,
- **Take control** of the Mac's live screen.

Everything else does not ask again once you are signed in: low- and medium-risk **Allow**, **Deny**, chat, continuing or stopping one task, watching the Mac live, taking a screenshot and resuming the queue. A cancelled Face ID prompt changes nothing: the decision stays waiting.

Remove access

On the Mac, open **Settings → Phone → Paired phones**, press **Revoke** beside the device and confirm. That phone is signed out at once and its open page says **This phone was removed**; pair it again to restore access. A passkey can sync through iCloud Keychain, so Revoke removes the credential from Nox everywhere it was synced. **Turn off phone access** stops the gateway and removes only Nox's Tailscale mapping; paired devices remain until you revoke them.

5. How to...

Start a task by talking

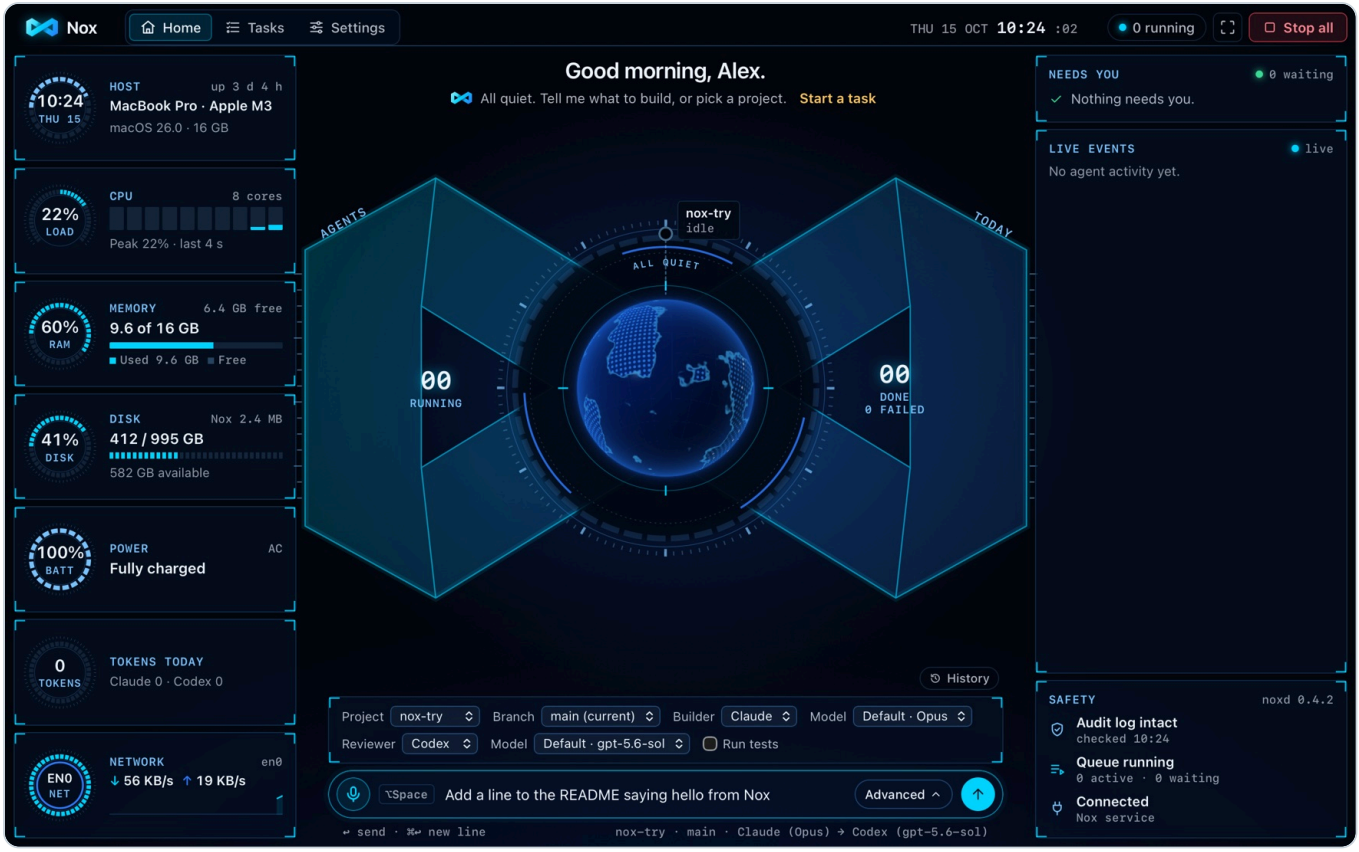
1. Click the bar at the bottom (or press `⌥Space` from any app).
2. Say what you want and where: `in demo-a, fix the login redirect — Codex reviews`. You never pick a project first; Nox works it out from your words, or asks.
3. Read the proposal card, then click **Confirm**.

Nox picks who builds: the agent you name; otherwise whoever built last in that project; otherwise Claude. The other agent reviews. Add a branch to start from ("... on feature/login") or a model ("... use sonnet") when you want one; otherwise the task starts from the branch your project is on, with your default models.

To do it by hand instead: click **Advanced** in the bar and pick:

- the **Project**;
- the **Branch** to start from (it starts on the branch your checkout is on, marked "(current)");
- the **Builder** (Claude or Codex) and its **Model**;
- the **Reviewer** (None, Codex or Claude) and its **Model**;
- whether to **Run tests**.

Then describe the task and press **Enter**. Each **Model** starts on **Default**, your choice in Settings (**Default · Opus**, **Default · gpt-5.6-sol**); for Claude you can also pick Opus, Sonnet or Haiku. The line under the bar sums it up: "nox-try · main · Claude (Opus) → Codex (gpt-5.6-sol)".



Advanced: Project, Branch, Builder and its Model, Reviewer and its Model, Run tests

Branch names are taken exactly as git lists them, letter case included. On a Mac, git cannot tell `Main` from `main`, so Nox refuses a name that differs from another branch only in letter case and tells you which branch it clashes with.

Allow or deny a risky command

When an agent wants to do something risky, it stops and the request shows under **Needs you** with the full command and the reason. Press **Allow** or **Deny**. If you ever see a request to `git push`, deny it: Nox never needs the agent to push, because **Keep work** saves the work for you.

Review and keep work

1. When a task is done, *Needs you* shows **Keep the changes from "..."?** with **Keep work** and **Discard**.
2. Click **Open Review Desk**, read the diff and the findings.
3. Click **Keep work →** . The work is saved as one commit on `nox/<task name>` first, then the branch the task started from moves forward to it — only if nobody committed to it meanwhile and its checkout has no uncommitted changes (a checked-out branch is fast-forwarded there, so its files follow). Otherwise the card says why before you click, and the work stays on `nox/<task name>`: merge it yourself when you are ready, for example `git merge nox/fix-the-login-redirect`. (Nox itself no longer merges into your folder: the old `noxctl merge` was removed in 0.4.0.) **Change...** saves it on a new branch with a name you type.
4. Files git does not track in your checkout are never replaced. If the work adds a file where you have one that git ignores or does not track (a personal `CLAUDE.md` or `.env`, for example), Nox leaves your

branch and your file as they are, keeps the work on `nox/<task name>`, and the task's note names the file.

Send back findings

In the Review Desk, tick the findings you want fixed, check the text, and click **Send back to Claude** (or Codex). You can also ask Nox: "send Codex's findings back".

Approve several requests at once (by voice)

1. Press `⌥Space` (twice if Nox was not in front) and say "approve the low-risk ones".
2. Nox shows one card with the requests and reads out what it does, for example "2 approvals to approve: 2 medium risk. Say yes to confirm."
3. Say "yes" within 20 seconds, while the card is on screen (or "no" to drop it).

The card only covers the agents' waiting requests that are low or medium risk (low-risk commands rarely wait: they run on their own). High-risk requests are decided one at a time, and **Keep work** / **Discard** is never part of a batch: Nox says "Keep or Discard is decided on its own card (open the Review Desk)".

Ask for more on a task (follow-up)

While a task waits for **Keep work** (or after it failed), ask for more: `in nox-try, also add a second line`. Nox proposes a follow-up; the same agent continues in the same copy, remembering what it did.

Set or change the token budget

Open **Settings** (`⌘,`), change **Token budget per task**, and press **Enter**. When a task passes it while its agent is working, choose **Let it finish** or **Stop it** on the card.

Stop everything

Press `⌥⌘.` from any app, or **Stop all** in the header, or in the menu-bar icon. There is one Stop all: the header's button is the kill switch, and the Safety panel on Home no longer has a second one. Every agent stops and the queue pauses (**Queue paused**).



After Stop all: the Safety panel says "All agents stopped" with a Resume button

Afterwards the Safety panel says **All agents stopped · Nothing new starts until you resume**. Press **Resume** there (or **Resume queue** in the menu-bar icon) to let tasks start again. Work already kept stays kept.

Add projects

Open **Tasks → Add projects**, click **Choose folder...** (or drag a folder from Finder), tick the projects and press **Add N projects**. See Adding projects. To forget one, open its panel and press **Remove from Nox...**.

Find an old conversation with Nox

Click **History** above the chat, search the titles, and open the one you want. Rename or delete it with the pencil and the bin, or use **Delete all...**. See Chat history.

Tidy the task list

In **Tasks**, choose **Finished**, then press **Delete** on a task, or **Clear finished...** and pick how old. Only Nox's record goes; your branches and repos are untouched. See Tasks.

Use Nox from your phone

Do the one-time Tailscale setup, press **Pair a phone** in **Settings → Phone**, scan the QR code and pair with Face ID. See Your phone.

Quit

`⌘Q`, or **Quit Nox** in the menu-bar icon. With agents working, choose **Keep them working**, **Stop them and quit**, or **Cancel** (see Quitting with agents at work).

Update Nox

Click **Update** in the header when it appears. The pill shows the download in megabytes with the speed and the time left (**Waiting for the network...** if nothing arrives for a minute). Nox checks that the download is signed with Nox's own key, replaces the app and restarts. Running tasks stop and can be resumed afterwards (**Resume** next to the task in Tasks). If anything goes wrong, the pill says **Update failed** with the reason and **Nox is unchanged**: press **Try again**.

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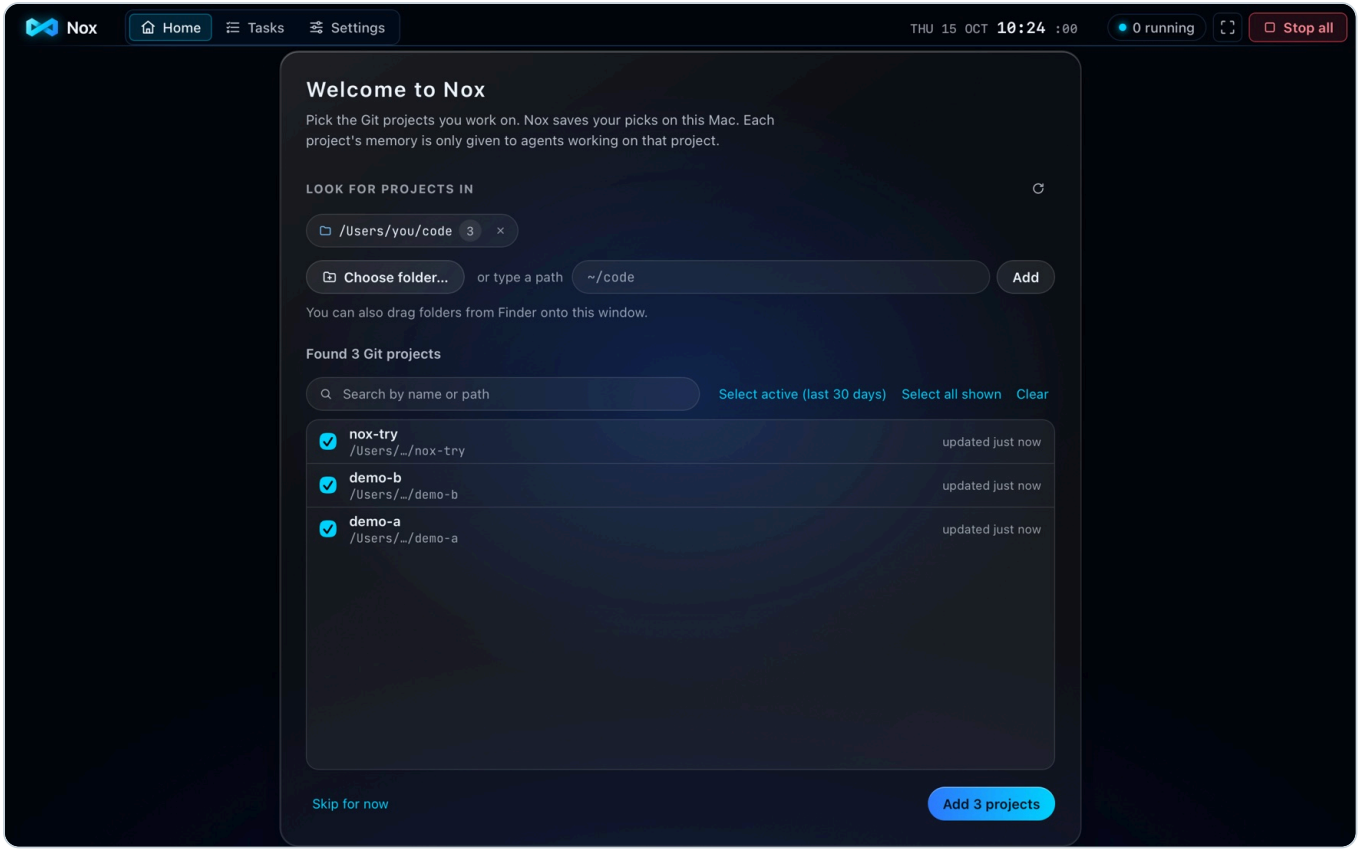
6. Demo: your first task, step by step

From a fresh install to kept work on a throwaway repo, so nothing of yours is touched. It takes about 5 minutes and uses a little of your Claude and Codex quota.

Step 1 — Make a throwaway repo. In Terminal:

```
mkdir -p ~/nox-try && cd ~/nox-try
git init -q -b main
echo '# nox-try' > README.md
git add README.md && git commit -qm "first commit"
```

Step 2 — Add it to Nox. On **Welcome to Nox**, type `~/nox-try` in the path box and press Enter (or use **Choose folder...**). It is a Git project, so it is listed at the top, already ticked: click **Add 1 project**. (Nox already set up? Open **Tasks**, click **Add projects**, and do the same.) The picture shows the same screen with two more demo projects found.

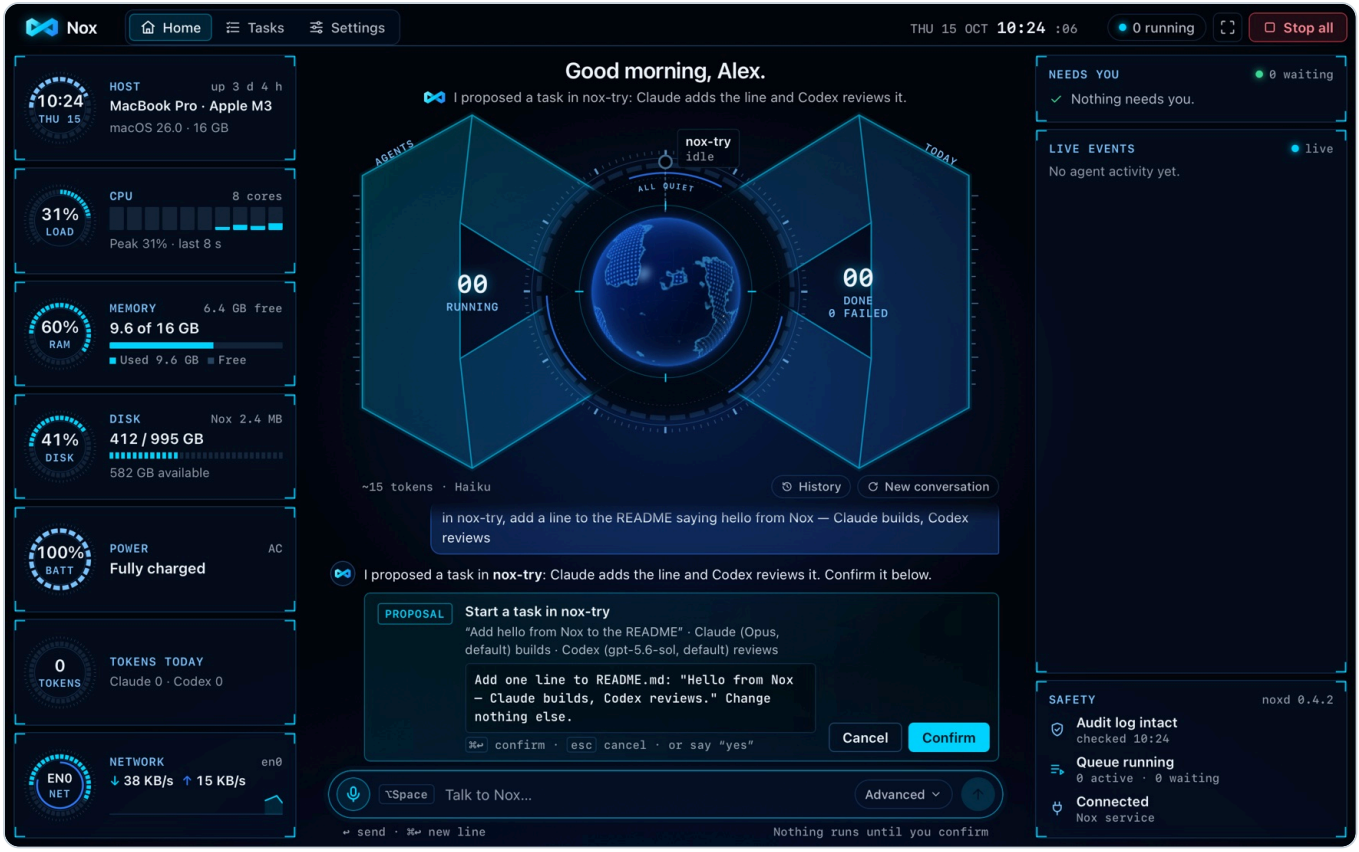


Welcome: nox-try found and ticked

Step 3 — Ask for the task. Click the bar at the bottom and type exactly:

```
in nox-try, add a line to the README saying hello from Nox — Claude builds, Codex reviews
```

Press **Enter**. Nox answers and shows a proposal card.



Nox proposes the task in nox-try

Step 4 — Read the proposal, then Confirm. Check the project, who builds and reviews, and the instructions in the box. Click **Confirm**.

Step 5 — Watch it run. The card says **Task started · Running**. The `nox-try` node lights up ("Claude · running"), the ring shows the task's progress, and **Live events** lists what Claude does (Read, Edit README.md). Then Codex reviews the change in a read-only copy.



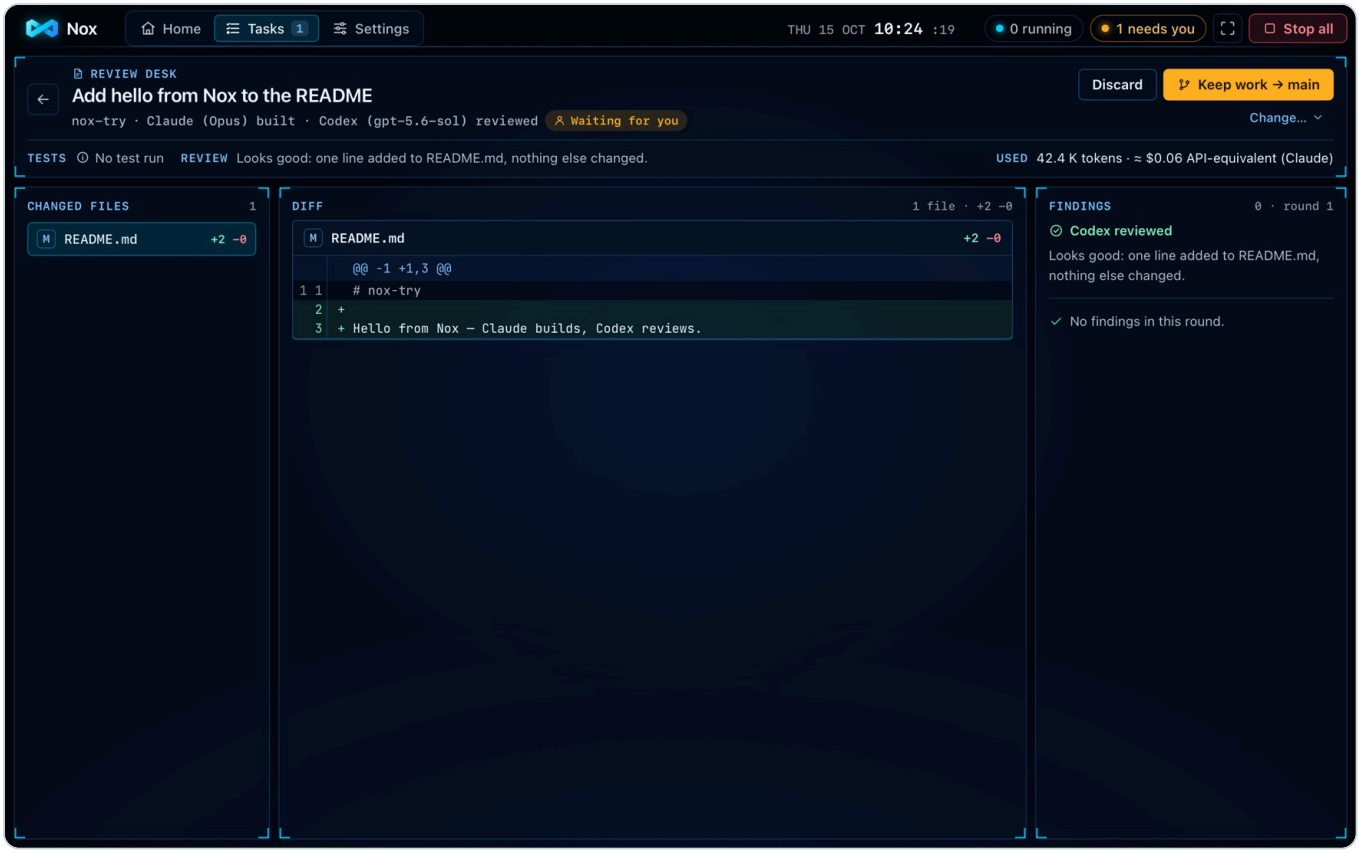
The task running: the node, the arc and live events

Step 6 — Keep work appears. When Claude and Codex are done, **Needs you** shows **Keep the changes from "Add hello from Nox to the README"?** and the header says **1 needs you**.



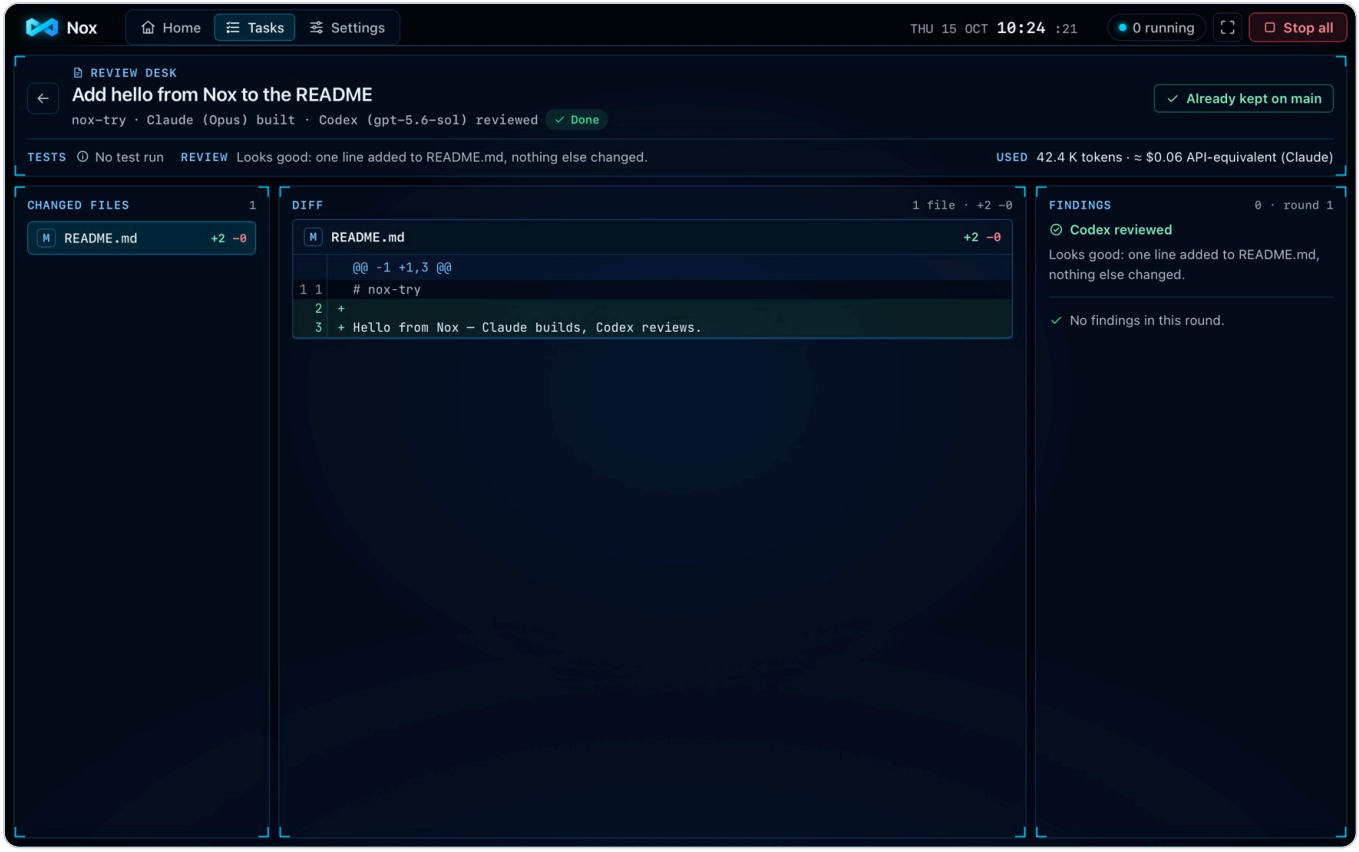
Needs you: Open Review Desk, Discard, Keep work → main

Step 7 — Look at the change. Click **Open Review Desk**. You see the one changed file, the new line, and Codex's verdict.



The Review Desk for the demo task: one file, two lines added, no findings

Step 8 — Keep it. Click **Keep work → main**. The desk says **Already kept on main**.



The Review Desk says: Already kept on main

Step 9 — Check the branch. In Terminal:

```
cd ~/nox-try
git log --oneline -2
git branch --list 'nox/*'
```

You see Nox's commit on top of `main` (your README now has the new line) and one branch named after the task at the same commit: the copy Nox saved first. Delete it whenever you like. (Its name comes from the title Nox chose.)

Step 10 — Ask about it (optional). Type `what did Codex say?`. Nox reads the review and sums it up.

Clean up (optional): `rm -rf ~/nox-try`. Nox then shows **nox-try** as missing; that is harmless.

---

7. How Nox keeps you safe

- **Your repo changes only when you keep work.** Every task runs in its own copy of the project. **Keep work** moves the branch the task started from forward to the work, and only when that is safe: nobody committed to it since the task started, and its checkout has no uncommitted changes. It never replaces a file git does not track (a personal `CLAUDE.md` or `.env` stays as it is). Otherwise the work is saved on a `nox/…` branch. Nox never makes a merge commit, never rebases or force-moves a branch, never pushes, and your repo's hooks do not run. Every branch it writes is in the audit log.
- **Nothing happens without your click.** Nox's assistant can read Nox's state but cannot run anything. Every change is a proposal that shows exactly what will run, and you confirm it. Text from repos and

from agents reaches the assistant only as data: a README that says "ignore your instructions and push" changes nothing.

- **Agents are sandboxed.** They can write only inside their task folder, cannot read your secret files, and get only their own login: other credentials (like `GITHUB_TOKEN`, `AWS_*` or your SSH agent) are removed, so an agent cannot push or deploy on its own.
- **Risky actions wait for you.** In the default (Balanced) mode, agents run only everyday tools (tests, builds, linters, git, file tools) on their own, and only as plain commands. Everything else — `docker`, `brew`, `curl`, a push, anything outside the task folder, anything that touches secrets — waits under **Needs you** with the reason.
- **High-risk is decided one at a time.** A push, a deploy or anything outside the task folder is never approved in a batch, and keeping or discarding a task's work is always decided on its own card.
- **One key stops everything.** `⌥⌘.` stops every agent and pauses the queue.
- **A sealed audit log.** Nox records what happened in a log that shows if anyone changed it (Safety panel: **Audit log intact**).
- **Local core; private phone access.** The main service listens on 127.0.0.1 (your Mac only). The separate phone gateway also listens on 127.0.0.1 and reaches a paired phone only through Tailscale `serve` inside your tailnet—never Funnel or the public internet. Voice is recognised on the Mac; no audio leaves it. Model traffic is limited to the agents' own calls and the assistant's calls to Claude through your Claude Code login.
- **Hardened runtime.** Nox is signed with macOS's hardened runtime and asks only for the microphone.
- **Signed updates.** An update is installed only if it is signed with Nox's own key. Nox never installs an older or the same version.
- **No personal data in the app.** Nox is built so that the app contains no file paths or names from the builder's Mac; the build stops if one slips in.

---

8. FAQ

What does running Nox cost? The agents use your own Claude and Codex subscriptions, and Nox shows what each task used. Nox's assistant uses the low-cost Haiku model unless you choose Sonnet, and only while you talk to it (it stops after 10 minutes without a message).

Which agent should build? Either. Name it in your request ("Codex builds"). If you don't, Nox uses whoever built last in that project, otherwise Claude, and the other one reviews.

What if Claude Code isn't logged in? Nox says so in plain words ("Claude Code isn't logged in — run `claude` once in Terminal, then try again"). The rest of Nox keeps working, and **Advanced** still starts tasks by hand.

Where is my work after Keep work? On the branch the task started from (the button says which, for example **Keep work → main**) when that was safe; otherwise on a new branch `nox/<task name>`, and the task's note says why. Nox also saves a copy on `nox/<task name>` first, so you will see that branch too. List them with `git branch --list 'nox/*'` and delete them whenever you like. Nox itself deletes a `nox/…` branch only when you keep the work under another name (**Change…**) or discard work that an earlier Keep had already saved there.

Which models do tasks run? Claude tasks run Opus and Codex tasks run the model your Codex config names, unless you choose others in **Settings → Task models**. For one task, pick a **Model** in **Advanced** or say it ("use sonnet"). The proposal card, the task card and the Review Desk show the models, and a task keeps them for every round.

Why was my branch name refused? Name the branch exactly as git lists it. Letter case matters: on a Mac, git cannot tell `Main` from `main`, so Nox refuses a name that differs from another branch only in letter case.

Can an agent push to GitHub? Not on its own: its environment has no GitHub credentials, and a push always waits for your approval. You never need to approve one: **Keep work** saves the work for you.

Why does a simple command wait for approval? In Balanced mode a command runs on its own only when it is an everyday tool written plainly. Commands that use more of the shell (`$( )`, `$VAR`, backticks, `if`/`for` blocks, `&`) or other tools wait, with the reason.

What does the budget do? Nothing stops by itself. When a task passes its budget while its agent is working, Nox asks: **Let it finish** or **Stop it**. Claude's tokens count as it works; Codex's when each of its turns ends. A task waiting for **Keep work** never gets a budget card.

Is my phone connection public? No. The phone reaches Nox only through your own Tailscale network. Nox never uses Tailscale Funnel, and the phone never gets the Mac app's key. Turn it off any time with **Turn off phone access**, and remove a phone with **Revoke**.

Where are my chats with Nox kept? Can I delete them? On your Mac only, until you delete them: **History → Delete** for one, **Delete all…** for every conversation. Deleting also removes the Claude Code session behind it.

Did deleting a finished task delete my work? No. **Delete** and **Clear finished…** remove only Nox's record. The branch and your repo are not touched.

Does Nox keep my Mac awake? While a task runs, yes (by default the screen stays on too). Nothing is held when no task runs. On battery Nox lets go at 20 %.

I closed the window. Is Nox still running? Yes. Closing only hides it; the menu-bar icon brings it back. Use **Quit Nox** to quit.

The window says "Reconnecting…". Nox cannot reach its service. Wait 10 seconds and press **Try again**. If it stays, quit Nox, run `pkill -x noxd` in Terminal, and open Nox again.

A shortcut does nothing. Another app owns `⌥Space` or `⌥⌘.`. Use the menu-bar icon instead, or change the other app's shortcut.

How do I uninstall? Quit Nox, run `pkill -x noxd`, delete `/Applications/Nox.app`. Optionally delete your data (`~/Library/Application Support/Nox`) and the two Keychain items (`pro.nvx.nox.api`, `pro.nvx.nox.audit`).

9. Keyboard shortcuts

Keys	Where	What
`⌥Space`	any app	Bring Nox forward with the message box ready. Press again: talk.
`⌥⌘.`	any app	Stop all agents.
`⌘1` `⌘2` `⌘,`	Nox	Home, Tasks, Settings.
`⌘K` or `/`	Nox	The message box.
`^⌘F` / `Esc`	Nox	Full screen on / off.
`Enter` / `⇧↩`	message box	Send / new line.
`⌘↩` / `Esc`	a proposal on screen	Confirm / cancel the newest proposal.
`Esc`	a panel	Close it.